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# The Rule of St. Benedict

St. Benedict of Nursia (c. 480–c. 547)

**TRADITION**
Catholic

**DATES**
Written c. 530–560 · Blair translation, 1906

**LENGTH**
Prologue and 73 short chapters · Plain and practical; most chapters take two minutes

**WHY READ IT**
The most influential rule of life in Western Christianity: seventy-three short chapters and a prologue in which St. Benedict orders a monastery as 'a school of the Lord's service' — prayer, work, reading, humility, silence, care of the sick and of guests, 'that in all things God may be glorified.' For fifteen centuries monks and nuns have lived by it, and its wisdom about community, authority, and the ordinary day keeps finding readers far outside cloister walls.

**BEST PLACE TO START**
Begin with the Prologue — Benedict speaks as a father to a son who is listening for a word of life. Chapter VII, 'Of Humility,' with its ladder of twelve degrees, is the Rule's most famous chapter.

**SOURCE**
St. Benedict of Nursia, The Rule of St. Benedict, translated by Dom Oswald Hunter Blair, O.S.B. (Fort Augustus: Abbey Press, 1906). Text fetched from a scan of that edition at the Internet Archive (archive.org); the Latin text printed alongside the English in that edition is not included. Because the text comes from a scanned old book, the scanning sometimes garbles a word.

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# Prologue

Hearken, O my son, to the precepts of thy Master, and incline the ear of thine heart; willingly receive and faithfully fulfil the admonition of thy loving Father, that thou mayest return by the labour of obedience to Him from Whom thou hadst departed through the sloth of disobedience. To thee, therefore, my words are now addressed, whosoever thou art that, renouncing thine own will, dost take up the strong and bright weapons of obedience, in order to fight for the Lord Christ, our true king.

In the first place, whatever good work thou beginnest to do, beg of Him with most earnest prayer to perfect; that He Who hath now vouchsafed to count us in the number of His children may not at

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Profogus

Exsurgamus ergo tandem aliquando, exci- 2 jan. apertis oculis nostris ad deificum lumen, attonitis auribus audiamus, divina quotidie clamans quid nos admoneat vox dicens: Hodie st vocem ejus audieritis, nolite obdurare corda vestra. |Ps. xciv. 8.] Et iterum: Quit habet aures audiendi, audiat quid Spiritus dicat ecclests. [Apoc. ii. 7.] Et quid dicit? Vente, filit, audite me; tiumorem Domini docebo vos. [Ps. xxxiii. 12.] Currite, dum lumen vite habetis, ne tenebre mortis vos comprehendant. (Joan. xii. 35.]

puli, cui hac clamat, operarium suum, iterum ee audiens, respondeas: Ego; dicit tibi Deus: Si vis habere veram et perpetuam vitam, prohibe linguam tuam a malo, et labia tua ne loquantur dolum.

any time be grieved by our evil deeds. For we must always so serve Him with the good things He hath given us, that not only may He never, as an angry father, disinherit His children, but may never, as a dreadful Lorp, incensed by our sins, deliver us to everlasting punishment, as most wicked servants who would not follow Him to glory.

Let us then at length arise, since the Scripture stirreth us up, saying: ‘“ It is time ssa. now for us to rise from sleep.”’ And our eyes being opened to the deifying light, let us hear with wondering ears what the Divine Voice admonisheth us, daily crying out: ‘To-day if ye shall hear His voice, harden not your hearts.” And again, ‘‘ He that hath ears to hear, let him hear what the Spirit saith to the churches.” And what saith Hee “Come, my children, hearken to Me, I will teach you the fear of the Lorp. Run while ye have the light of life, lest the darkness of death seize hold of you.”

And the Lorp, seeking His own workman in the multitude of the people to whom He thus crieth out, saith again: “‘ Who is the man that will have life, and desireth to see good days?” And if thou, hearing Him, answer, ‘‘I am he,” God saith to thee: “If thou wilt have true and everlasting life, keep thy tongue from evil and thy lips that they speak no guile. Turn from evil, and do good: seek peace and pursue it. And when you

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Profogus

rum actuum lumbis nostris, per ducatum i Sept Evangelii pergamus itinera ejus, ut mereamur eum, habitare, nisi illuc bonis actibus currendo, minime num, dicentes ei: Domine, quis habitabit in sancto tuo? [Ps. xiv. 4.] Post hance interrogationem, fratres, audiamus Dominum respondentem, dicentem: Quit ingreditur sine macula, et operaprobrium non accepit adversus proximum suum. [Ps. xiv. 2, 8.] Qui malignum diabolum aliqua suadentem sibi, cum ipsa suasione sua a conspectibus cordis sui respuens, deduxit ad nihilum, Christum. [Ps. cxxxvi. 9.]

have done these things, My eyes will be upon you, and My ears will be open to your prayers; and before you call upon Me, I will say unto you, ‘ Behold, I am here’.”’ What can be sweeter to us, dearest brethren, than this voice of the Lorp inviting us? Behold in his loving kindness the Lorp sheweth unto us the way of life.

Having our loins, therefore, girded with 4, ie faith and the performance of good works, Ace let us walk in His paths by the guidance of the Gospel, that we may deserve to see Him Who

hath called us to His kingdom. And if we wish ~

to dwell in the tabernacle of His kingdom, we shall by no means reach it unless we run thither by our good deeds. But let us ask the Lorp with the prophet, saying to Him: “Lord, who shall dwell in Thy tabernacle, or who shall rest upon Thy holy hill?’ After this question, brethren, let us hear the Lorp answering, and shewing to us the way to His tabernacle, and saying: ‘“ He that walketh without stain and worketh justice: he that speaketh truth in his heart, that hath not done guile with his tongue: he that hath done no evil to his neighbour, and hath not taken up a reproach against his neighbour”: he that hath brought the malignant evil one to naught, casting him out of his heart with all his suggestions, and hath taken his bad thoughts, while they were yet young, and dashed them down upon the (Rock) Christ. These are they,

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Profogus

audit verba mea hec, et facit ea, similabo eum viro saptenti, qui edificavit domum suam supra petram: venerunt flumina, flaverunt venti, data enim erat supra petram. [Matth. vii. 24, seq. ] Hzec complens Dominus, exspectat quotidie his suis sanctis monitis factis nos respondere debere. Ideo nobis propter emendationem malorum hujus vitae, dies ad inducias relaxantur, dicente Apostolo: adducit? [Rom. ii. 4.] Nam pius Dominus et vivat. [Ezech. xviii. 23.]

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who fearing the Lorp, are not puffed up with their own good works, but knowing that the good which is in them cometh not from themselves but from the Lorp, magnify the Lorp

Who worketh in them, saying with the prophet: “Not unto us, O Lorp, not unto us, but unto Thy Name give the glory.” So the Apostle Paul imputed nothing of His preaching to himself, but said: “ By the grace of God Iam what lam.” And again he saith: ‘“ He that glorieth, let him glory in the Lorp.”

Hence also the Lorp saith in the Gospel: ‘‘ He that heareth these words of Mine, s and doeth them, is like a wise man who built his house upon a rock: the floods came, the winds blew, and beat upon that house, and it fell not, because it was founded upon a rock.” And the Lorp in fulfilment of these His words is waiting daily for us to respond by our deeds to His holy admonitions. Therefore are the days of our life lengthened for the amendment of our evil ways, as saith the Apostle, ‘ Knowest thou not that the patience of God is leading thee to repentance?” For the merciful Lorp saith: “I will not the death of a sinner, but that he should be converted and live.”

Since then, brethren, we have asked of the Lorp who is to inhabit His temple, we have b heard His commands to those who are to dwell there: and if we fulfil those duties, we shall be

minus habet in nobis natura possibile, rogemus Dominum, ut gratiz suze jubeat nobis adjutorium vitam volumus pervenire perpetuam, dum adhuc hanc lucis viam vacat implere, currendum et agen-

schola servitii; in qua institutione nihil asperum, nihil grave nos constituturos speramus. tatis ratione, propter emendationem vitiorum, vel conservationem caritatis processerit, non illico pavore perterritus refugias viam salutis, que non est nisi angusto initio incipienda. Processu vero conversationis et fidei, dilatato corde, inenarrabili dilectionis dulcedine curritur via mandatorum Dei;

Amen.

heirs of the kingdom of heaven. Our hearts, therefore, and our bodies must be made ready to fight under the holy obedience of His commands ; and let us ask God to supply by the help of His grace what by nature is not possible to us. And if we would arrive at eternal life, escaping the pains of hell, then—while there is yet time, while we are still in the flesh, and are able to fulfil all these things by the light which is given us—we must hasten to do now what will profit us for all eternity.

We have, therefore, to establish a Z a school of the Lorp’s service, in the setting forth of which we hope to order nothing that is harsh or rigorous. But if anything be somewhat strictly laid down, according to the dictates of sound reason, for the amendment of vices or the preservation of charity, do not therefore fly in dismay from the way of salvation, whose beginning cannot but be strait and difficult. But as we go forward in our life and in faith, we shall with hearts enlarged and unspeakable sweetness of love run in the way of God’s commandments; so that never departing from His guidance, but persevering in His teaching in the monastery until death, we may by patience share in the sufferings of Christ, that we may deserve to be partakers of His kingdom. Amen.

12 Regufa S. Benedicti

174) ra manifestum est. Primum &

cogitationum, Deo auxiliante, pugnare sufficiunt. Tertium vero monachorum deterrimum genus est - natura molliti, adhuc operibus servantes szculo

CHAPTER I

# Of the several kinds of Monks and their way of life

a fea | is well known that there are 8 Jan. : ; four kinds of monks. The first $ Sept.

are the Cenobites: that is those in

monasteries, who live under a rule or an Abbot. The second are the Anchorites or Hermits: that is those who, not in the first fervour of religious life, but after long probation in the monastery, have learned by the help and experience of many to fight against the devil; and going forth well armed from the ranks of their brethren to the single-handed combat of the desert, are able, without the support of others, to fight by the strength of their own arm, God helping them, against the vices of the flesh and their evil thoughts. A third and most baneful kind of monks are the Sarabites, who have been tried by no rule nor by the experience of a master, as gold in the furnace ; but, being as soft as lead, and still serving the world in their works, are known by their tonsure to lie to God. These in twos or threes, or even singly, without a shepherd, shut up, not in the Lorp’s sheepfolds, but in their own,

14 Regufa S. Benedicti

CAPUT II.

QUALIS ESSE DEBEAT ABBAS.

*Note A.—Fortisstmum genus.

make a law to themselves in the pleasure of their own desires: whatever they think fit or choose to do, that they call holy; and what they like not, that they consider unlawful.

The fourth kind of monks are those called “ Girovagi,” who spend all their lives long wandering about divers provinces, staying in different cells for three or four days at a time, ever roaming, with no stability, given up to their own pleasures and to the snares of gluttony, and worse in all things than the Sarabites. Of the most wretched life of these it is better to say nothing than to speak. Leaving them alone therefore, let us set to work, by the help of God, to lay down a rule for-the Cenobites, that is, the strongest” kind of monks.

CHAPTER II

# What kind of man the Abbot ought to be

Sea iN Abbot who is worthy to rule 9 Jan. Us| over the monastery ought always 9 Sert. to remember what he is called, and

correspond to his name of superior by his deeds. For he is believed to hold the place of Christ in the monastery, since he is called by His name, as the Apostle saith: ‘Ye have received the

spirit of the adoption of children, in which we cry .

Abba, Father.” And therefore the Abbot ought not (God forbid) to teach, or ordain, or command any-

16 Begufa S. Benedictt

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contrary to the law of the Lorp ; but let his bidding and his doctrine be infused into the minds of his disciples like the leaven of divine justice.

Let the Abbot be ever mindful that at the 10 Jan. dreadful judgment of God an account will 1 a have to be given both of his own teaching and of ° the obedience of his disciples. And let him know that to the fault of the shepherd shall be imputed any lack of profit which the father of the household may find in his sheep. Only then shall he be acquitted, if he shall have bestowed alli pastoral diligence on his unquiet and disobedient flock, and ° employed all his care to amend their corrupt manner of life: then shall he be absolved in the judgment of the Lorp, and may say to the Lorp with the prophet: “I have not hidden Thy justice in my heart, I have declared Thy truth and Thy salvation, but they contemned and despised me.” And then at length the punishment of death shall be inflicted on the disobedient sheep. :

Therefore, when any one receiveth the :: Jan: name of Abbot, he ought to govern his dis- i cath < ciples by a two-fold teaching: that is, he should shew forth all goodness and holiness by his deeds rather than his words: declaring to the intelligent among his disciples the commandments of the Lorp by words: but tothe hard-hearted and the

simple-minded setting forth the divine precepts by

18 Regufa S. Benedicti

the example of his deeds. And let him shew by his own actions that those things ought not to be done which he has taught his disciples to be against the law of God; lest, while preaching to others, he should himself become a castaway, and God should say to him in his sin: ‘ Why dost thou declare My justice, and take My covenant in thy mouth ? Thou hast hated discipline, and hast cast My words behind thee.” And again, ‘‘ Thou who sawest the mote in thy brother’s eye, didst thou not see the beam in thine own?”

Let him make no distinction of persons in 12 Jan. the monastery. Let not one be loved

more 2 Serk than another, unless he be found to excel in good works or in obedience. Let not one of noble birth be put before him that was formerly a slave, unless some other reasonable cause exist for it. But if upon just consideration it should so seem good to the Abbot, let him arrange as he please concerning the place of any one whomsoever ; but, otherwise, let them keep their own places; because, whether bond or free, we are all one in Christ, and bear an equal rank in the service of one Lorn: “for with God there is no respecting of persons.” Only for one reason are we preferred in His sight, if we be found to surpass others in good works and in

humility. Let the Abbot, then, shew equal love to ,

all, and let the same discipline be imposed upon all according to their deserts.

20 Gesufo a Bencdiern

tS aosaas sua namque Abbas in antolica 13 Jan, debet illam semper formam servare, in qua 13 Sept dicitur: Argue, obsecra, increpa: [2 Tim. iv. 2] id est, miscens temporibus tempora, terroribus blandimenta: dirum magistri, pium patris ostendat

For the Abbot in his doctrine ought always "3 Jan. to observe the bidding of the Apostle, where- 33 Bet in he says: ‘* Reprove, entreat, rebuke”: mingling, as occasions may require, gentleness with severity ; shewing now the rigour of a master, now the loving . affection of a father, so as sternly to rebuke the undisciplined and restless, and to exhort the obedient, mild, and patient to advance in virtue. And such as are negligent and haughty we charge him to reprove and correct. Let him not shut his eyes to the faults of offenders; but as soon as they appear, let him strive with all his might to root them out, remembering the fate of Heli, the priest of Silo. Those of good disposition and understanding let him, for the first or second time, . correct only with words; but such as are froward and hard of heart, and proud, or disobedient, let » him chastise with bodily stripes at the very first offence, knowing that it is written: ‘“ The fool is not corrected with words.” And again: “ Strike thy son with the rod, and thou shalt deliver his soul from death.”

The Abbot ought always to remember “4 vant what he is, and what he is called, and to 23 Sis : know that to whom more is committed, from him more is required ; and he must consider how difficult and arduous a task he hath undertaken, of

ruling souls and adapting himself to many disposi-

22 Regufa S. Benedicti

tions. Let him so accommodate and suit himself to the character and intelligence of each, winning some by kindness, others by reproof, others by persuasion, that he may not only suffer no loss in the flock committed to him, but may even rejoice in their virtuous increase.

Above all let him not, overlooking or 15 Jan.

undervaluing the salvation of the souls en- 1s Sept. ’

trusted to him, be too solicitous for fleeting, earthly, and perishable things; but let him ever bear in mind that he hath undertaken the government of souls, of which he shall have to give an account. And that he may not complain for want of worldly substance, let him remember what is written: “ Seek first the kingdom of God and His justice, and all these things shall be added unto you.” And again: “ Nothing is wanting to them that fear Him.”

And let him know that he who hath undertaken

the government of souls, must prepare himself to’

render an account of them. And whatever may be the number of the brethren under his care, let him be certainly assured that on the Day of Judgment he will have to give an account to the Lorp of all these souls, as well as of his own. And thus,

being ever fearful of the coming inquiry which the

Shepherd will make into the state of the flock committed to him, while he is careful on other men’s account, he will be solicitous also on his

a Reaufla S. Bencdicti

CAPOUT III.

own. And so, while correcting others by his admonitions, he will be himself cured of his own defects.

CHAPTER III

# Of calling the Brethren to Council

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have to be transacted in the 16 Sept. monastery, let the Abbot call together | the whole community, and himself declare what is the question to be settled. And, having heard the counsel of the brethren, let him consider within himself, and then do what he shall judge most expedient. We have said that all should be called to council, because it is often to the younger that the Lorp revealeth what is best. But let the brethren give their advice with all subjection and humility, and not presume stubbornly to defend their own opinion; but rather let the matter rest with the Abbot's discretion, that all may submit to whatever he shall judge to be best. Yet, even as it becometh disciples to obey their

master, so doth it behove him to order all things -

prudently and with justice.

Let all, therefore, follow the Rule in all 17 Jan.

; . : 18 M things as their guide, and let no man rashly 17 Sept.

turn aside from it. Let no one in the monastery

26 Regufa 3S. Benediett

CAPUT IV.

Ss ewN primis, Dominum Deum dili- 13 Jan. 7 Wes gere ex toto corde, tota anima, 18 sete | tota virtute. 2. Deinde proximum tamquam teip-

follow the will of his own heart: nor let any one presume insolently to contend with his Abbot, either within or without the monastery. But if he should so presume, let him be subjected to the discipline appointed by the Rule. The Abbot himself, however, must do everything with the fear of God and in observance of the Rule: knowing that he will have without doubt to render to God, the most just Judge, an account of all his judgments. If it happen that less important matters have to be transacted for the good of the monastery, let him take counsel with the Seniors only, as it is written : “Do all things with counsel, and thou shalt not afterwards repent it.”

CHAPTER IV

# What are the Instruments of Good Works

memeesegN the first place, to love the :8 Jan. Yas e ; : 19 May Lorp God with all one’s heart, 18 Sept. all one’s soul, and all one’s strength. 2. Then, one’s neighbour as oneself. 3. Then not to kill. 4, Not to commit adultery. 5. Not to steal. 6 7 8

. Not to covet. . Not to bear false witness. . To honour all men.

28 Regufa S. Genedicti

25. Pacem falsam non dare.

26. Caritatem non derelinquere.

31. Inimicos diligere.

33. Persecutionem pro justitia sustinere.

Rule of St. Benediet ee

Not to do to another what one would not

have done to oneself.

10. it; . Not to seek after delicate living. . To love fasting.

To deny oneself, in order to follow Christ. To chastise the body.

. To relieve the poor. . To clothe the naked.

To visit the sick.

. To bury the dead.

To help in affliction.

. To console the sorrowing.

To keep aloof from worldly actions.

. To prefer nothing to the love of Christ.

. Not to give way to anger. 19 Jan.

. Not to harbour a desire of revenge. 19 Sept. . Not to foster guile in one’s heart. . Not to make a feigned peace.

Not to forsake charity.

. Not to swear, lest perchance one forswear

oneself.

To utter truth from heart and mouth. Not to render evil for evil.

32. Not to render cursing for cursing, but rather blessing. 33, To bear persecution for justice sake.

30 Regufa S, Benedicti

34. Non esse superbum.

35. Non vinolentum.

36. Non multum edacem.

37. Non somnolentum.

38. Non pigrum.

39. Non murmurosum.

40. Non detractorem.

41, Spem suam Deo committere.

51, Et seniori spirituali patefacere.

34. Not to be proud.

35. Not given to wine.

36. Not a glutton.

37. Not drowsy.

38. Not slothful.

39. Not a murmurer.

40. Not a detractor.

41. To put one’s hope in God.

42. To attribute any good that one sees in oneself to God, and not to oneself.

43. But to recognise and always impute to oneself the evil that one doth.

44, To fear the Day of Judgment. ae Pauw:

46. To desire with all spiritual longing everlasting life.

48. To keep guard at all times over the actions of one’s life.

49. To know for certain that God sees one everywhere.

50. To dash down on the (Rock) Christ one’s evil thoughts, the instant that they come into the heart :

51. And to lay them open to one’s spiritual father.

52. To keep one’s mouth from evil and wicked words.

53. Not to love much speaking.

Regufa S. Wenedicti

58. Lectiones sanctas libenter audire.

57. Orationi frequenter incumbere.

64. Nullum odire.

66. Contentionem non amare.

67. Elationem fugere.

68. Seniores venerari.

69. Juniores diligere.

54. Not to speak vain words or such as move to laughter.

55, Not to love much or excessive laughter.

58. Daily to confess one’s past sins with tears and sighs to God, and to amend them for the time to come.

59. Not to fulfil the desires of the flesh: to hate one’s own will.

60. To obey in all things the commands of the . Abbot, even though he himself (which God forbid) should act otherwise : being mindful of that precept © of the Lorp: “ What they say, do ye; but what they do, do ye not.”

61. Not to wish to be called holy before one is so: but first to be holy, that one may be truly so called.

62. Daily to fulfil by one’s deeds the com- 2: Jan. mandments of God. aEdega

63. To love chastity.

64, To hate no man.

65. Not to give way to jealousy and envy.

66. Not to love strife.

67, To fly from vainglory.

68. To reverence the Seniors,

69. To love the juniors.

70. To pray for one’s enemies in the love of Christ.

34 Regula S. Benedicti

tione.

CAPUT V. De OBEDIENTIA.

convenit his, qui nihil sibi Christo

71. To make peace with an adversary before the setting of the sun. 72. And never to despair of the mercy of God.

Behold, these are the tools of the spiritual craft, which, if they be constantly employed day and night, and duly given back on the day of judgment, will gain for us from the Lorp that

reward which He Himself hath promised—“ which eye hath not seen, nor ear heard; nor hath it entered into the heart of man to conceive what God hath prepared for them that love Him.” And the workshop where we are to labour at all these things is the © cloister of the monastery, and stability in the community.

CHAPTER V

# Of Obedience

a =a HE first degree of humility is 22 re obedience without delay. This 22 Sept. becometh those who hold nothing dearer to them than Christ, and who on account of the holy servitude which they have taken upon them, either for fear of hell or for the glory of life everlasting, as soon as anything is ordered by the superior, suffer no more delay in

36 Regufa S, Benedict

doing it than if it had been commanded by God Himself... It is of these that the Lorp saith: ‘At the hearing of the ear he hath obeyed Me.” And, again, to teachers He saith: “He that heareth you heareth Me.”

Such as these, therefore, leaving immediately their own occupations and forsaking their own will, with their hands disengaged, and leaving unfinished what they were about, with the speedy step of obedience follow by their deeds the voice of him who commands; and so as it were at the same instant the bidding of the master and the perfect . fulfilment of the disciple are joined together in the swiftness of the fear of God by those who are moved with the desire of attaining eternal life. These, therefore, choose the narrow way, of which the Lorp saith: ‘Narrow is the way which leadeth unto life’; so that living not by their own will, nor obeying their own desires and pleasures, but walking according to the judgment and command ° of another, and dwelling in community, they desire to have an Abbot over them. Such as these without doubt fulfil that saying of the Lorp: ‘‘I came not to do Mine own will, but the will of Him Who sent Me.”

But this very obedience will then only be 23 Jan. acceptable to God and sweet to men, if what 23 oe is commanded be done not fearfully, tardily, nor coldly, nor with murmuring, nor with an answer,

Regufa S. Benedictt

CAPUT VI.

DE TACITURNITATE.

shewing unwillingness ; for the obedience which is given to superiors is given to God, since He Himself hath said: ‘He that heareth you, heareth Me.” And it ought to be given by disciples with a good will, because “God loveth a cheerful giver.” For if the disciple obey with ill-will, and murmur not only with his lips but even in his heart, although he fulfil the command, yet it will not be accepted by God, Who regardeth the heart of the murmurer. And for such an action he shall gain no reward ; nay, rather, he shall incur the punishment due to murmurers, unless he amend and make satisfaction.

CHAPTER VI

# Of the Practice of Silence

galET us do as saith the prophet: 24 Ae

4 ‘‘I said, I will take heed to my 24 Sept. l ways, that I sin not with my tongue, I = have placed a watch over my mouth ;

I became dumb and was silent, and held my peace even from good things.’ Here the prophet sheweth that if we ought at times to refrain even from good words for the sake of silence, how much more ought we to abstain from evil words, on account of the punishment due to sin. Therefore, on account of the importance of silence, let leave to speak be

Regufa S. Benedictt

CAPUT VII.

De HuMILITATE.

seldom granted even to perfect disciples,” although their conversation be good and holy and tending to edification; because it is written: ‘In much speaking thou shalt not avoid sin” ; and elsewhere : “ Death and life are in the power of the tongue.” For it becometh the master to speak and to teach, but it beseemeth the disciple to be silent and to listen. And therefore, if anything has to be asked of the Superior, let it be done with all humility and » subjection of reverence. But as for buffoonery or idle words, such as move to laughter, we utterly condemn them in every place, nor do we allow the

disciple to open his mouth in such discourse.

CHAPTER VII

# Of Humility

eres eee Holy Scripture crieth out to 25 i Mus, brethren, saying: ‘“ Every 25 Sept. one that exalteth himself shall be humbled, and he who humbleth himself shall be exalted.” In saying this, it teacheth us that all exaltation is a kind of pride, against which the prophet sheweth himself to be on his guard when he saith: ‘ Lorp, my heart is not exalted nor mine eyes lifted up ; nor have I walked

in great things, nor in wonders above me.” For

42 Regufa S. Benedicti

Rule of Sf. Benedict 43 why? “If I did not think humbly, but exalted my soul: like a child that is weaned from his mother, so wilt Thou requite my soul.’”’ Whence, brethren, if we wish to arrive at the highest point of humility, and speedily to reach that heavenly exaltation to which we can only ascend by the humility of this present life, we must by our ever-ascending actions erect such a ladder as that which Jacob beheld in his dream, by which the angels appeared to him descending and ascending. This descent and ascent signifieth nothing else than that we descend by selfexaltation and ascend by humility. And the ladder thus erected is our life in the world, which, if the heart be humbled, is lifted up by the Lorp to heaven. The sides of the same ladder we understand to be our body and soul, in which our divine vocation hath placed various degrees of humility or discipline, which we must ascend.

The first degree of humility, then, is that 26 Jan. a man always keep the fear of God before a6 pe his eyes, avoiding all forgetfulness ; and that he be ever mindful of all that God hath commanded, bethinking himself that those who despise God will be consumed in hell for their sins, and that life everlasting is prepared for them that fear Him. And keeping himself at all times from sin and vice, whether of the thoughts, the tongue, the hands, the feet, or his own will, let him thus hasten to cut off the desires of the flesh.

Regufa S. Benediett

Bute of St. iGenedict 45

Let aa consider that ba is oo beheld 27 ae from heaven by God, and that his actions os ne are everywhere seen by the eye of the Divine Majesty, and are every hour reported to Him by His angels. This the prophet telleth us, when he

sheweth how God is ever present in our thoughts, ~ é

* ee

saying : “ God searcheth the heart and the reins” And again: “The Lorp knoweth the thoughts of men.” And he also saith : “Thou hast understood my thoughts afar off’’; and ‘“ The thought of man shall confess to Thee.” In order, therefore, that he may be on his guard against evil thoughts, let the humble brother say ever in his heart: “Then shall I be unspotted before Him, if I shall have kept me from mine iniquity.” |

We ate, indeed, forbidden to do our own 28 Jan. will by Scripture, which saith to us: “ Turn 2: Sept away from thine own will.” And so too we beg of God in prayer that His will may be done in us. Rightly therefore are we taught not to do our own will, if we take heed to the warning of Scripture : “There are ways which to men seem right, but the ends thereof lead to the depths of hell” ; or, again, when we tremble at what is said of the careless: “They are corrupt and have become abominable in their pleasures.”” And in regard to the desires of the flesh, we must believe that God is always present to us, as the prophet saith to the Lorn: “O Lorp, all my desire is before Thee.”

46 Regula 8. Benedicti

Let us be on our guard then against evil 29 Jan. desires, since death hath its seat close to the 29 Sept entrance of delight ; wherefore the Scripture commandeth us, saying: ‘“‘Go not after thy concupiscences.”’ Since, therefore, the eyes of the Lorp behold the good and the evil; and the Lorp is ever looking down from heaven upon the children of men, to see who hath understanding or is seeking God; and since the works of our hands are reported to Him day and night by the angels appointed to watch over us; we must be always on the watch, brethren, lest, as the prophet saith in the psalm, God should see us at any time declining to evil and become unprofitable ; and lest, though He Spare us now, because He is merciful and expecteth our conversion, He should say to us hereafter : “ These things thou didst and I held My peace.”

The second degree of humility is, that a 40 Jan. man love not his own will, nor delight in s sen : gratifying his own desires; but carry out in his deeds that saying of the Lorn: “I came not to do mine own will, but the will of Him Who sent me.” And again Scripture saith: Self-will hath punishment, but necessity wins a crown.*

The third degree of humility is, that a man_ 31 Jan. for the love of God submit himself to his 1c superior in all obedience; imitating the Lorp, of Whom the apostle saith: ‘‘ He was made obedient even unto death.”

48 Begufa 5. Benedict

[2 Cor. xi. 26.]

The fourth degree of humility is, that if in x Feb. this very obedience hard and contrary things, ee nay even injuries, are done to him, he should embrace them patiently with a quiet conscience, and , not grow weary or give in, as the Scripture saith: “ He that shall persevere to the end shall be saved.” And again: ‘‘ Let thy heart be comforted, and wait for the Lorp.”’ And shewing how the faithful man ought to bear all things, however contrary, for the Lorp, it saith in the person of the afflicted: “ Por Thee we suffer death all the day long; we are esteemed as sheep for the slaughter.” And secure in their hope of the divine reward, they go on with joy, saying: ‘ But in all these things we overcome, through Him Who hath loved us.’ And so in another place Scripture saith: ‘Thou hast proved us, O God; Thou has tried us as silver is tried by fire ; Thou hast led us into the snare, and hast laid tribulation on our backs,”’ And in order to shew that we ought to be under a superior, it goes on to say: ‘* Thou hast placed men over our heads.” Moreover, fulfilling the

precept of the Lorp by patience in adversities and injuries, they who are struck on one cheek offer the other: to him who taketh away their coat they leave also their cloak ; and being forced to walk one mile, they go two. With Paul the Apostle, they bear with false brethren, and bless those that curse them,

50 Regufa S. Benedieti

semper tecum. [Ps. Ixxii. 22, 23.]

The fifth degree of humility is, not to hide 2 Feb. from one's Abbot any of the evil thoughts oon that beset one's heart, or the sins committed in secret, but humbly to confess them. Concerning which the Scripture exhorteth us, saying: '' Make known thy way unto the Lorp, and hope in Him." And again: ' Confess to the Lorp, for He is good, and His mercy endureth for ever." So also the prophet saith: "I have made known to Thee mine offence, and mine iniquities I have not hidden. | will confess against myself my iniquities to the Lorp: and Thou hast forgiven the wickedness of

my heart."'

The sixth degree of humility is, fora monk 3 Feb. to be contented with the meanest and worst ee. of everything, and in all that is enjoined him to esteem himself a bad and worthless labourer, saying with the prophet: 'I have been brought to nothing, and I knew it not: I am become as a beast before Thee, yet | am always with Thee."

The seventh degree of humility is, that he 4 Feb. should not only call himself with his tongue Sten lower and viler than all, but also believe himself in his inmost heart to be so, humbling himself, and saying with the prophet: "I am a worm and no man, the shame of men and the outcast of the people: I have been exalted, and cast down, and confounded." And again: " It is good for me that

52 Regufa S. Benedicti

Thou hast humbled me, that I may learn Thy commandments."'

The eighth degree of humility is, for a "aes monk to do nothing except what is author- 6 Oct. ised by the common rule of the monastery, or the example of his seniors.

The ninth degree of humility is, that a 6 Feb. monk refrain his tongue from speaking, pO keeping silence until a question be asked him, as the Scripture sheweth: "In much talking thou shalt not avoid sin": and, " The talkative man shall not be directed upon the earth."

The tenth degree of humility is, that he ee be not easily moved and prompt to laughter ; 8 Oct. because it is written : '' The fool lifteth up his voice in laughter."

The eleventh degree of humility is, that ee when a monk speaketh, he do so gently and ober without laughter, humbly, gravely, with few and reasonable words, and that he be not noisy in his speech, as it is written: ''A wise man is known by the fewness of his words."

The twelfth degree of humility is, that the 9 Feb. monk, not only in his heart but also in his ie Ock, very exterior, always shew his humility to all who see him: that is, in the work of

God, in the oratory, in the monastery, in the garden, on the road, in the field, or wherever he may be, whether sitting, walking or standing, with head always bent down,

54 Regufa J. Benedictt

Note D.—Octava hora.

and eyes fixed on the earth, that he ever think of the guilt of his sins, and imagine himself already present before the terrible judgment-seat of God: always saying in his heart what the publican in the Gospel said with his eyes fixed on the earth: “ Lorp, I a sinner am not worthy to raise mine eyes to heaven.” And again, with the prophet: ‘I am bowed down and humbled on every side.”’

Having, therefore, ascended all these degrees of humility, the monk will presently arrive at that love of God which, being perfect, casteth out fear: whereby he shall begin to keep, without labour, and as it were naturally and by custom, all those precepts which he had hitherto observed through fear : no longer through dread of hell, but for the love of Christ, and of a good habit and a delight in virtue: which God will vouchsafe to manifest by the Holy Spirit in his labourer, now cleansed from vice and sin.

CHAPTER VIII

# Of the Divine Office at Night

“=m@a\N winter time, that is, from the 1 Feb. : first of November until Easter, mba the brethren shall rise at what may be reasonably calculated to be the eighth

hour of the night ;* so that having rested till some



time past midnight, they may rise having had their full sleep. And let the time that remains after the Night-Office be spent in study by those brethren who have still some part of the psalter and lessons to learn. But from Easter to the first of November let the hour for the Night-Office be so arranged that, after a very short interval, during which the brethren may go out for the necessities of nature, Lauds, which are to be said at day-break, may follow without delay.

CHAPTER IX

# How many Psalms are to be said at the Night-Hours

Wie ge alN winter time, after beginning with 1 reb. |} §6the verse, “ O God, come to my Eras assistance ; O Lord, make haste to help me,’ with the Gloria, let the words, ‘ O Lord, Thou wilt open my lips, and my mouth shall declare Thy praise,” be next repeated thrice ; then the third Psalm, with a Gloria, after which the ninety-fourth Psalm is to be said or sung, with an antiphon. Next let a hymn follow, and then six Psalms with antiphons. These being said, and also a versicle, let the Abbot give the blessing: and, all being seated, let three lessons be read by the

58 Regufa S. Benedicti

ASRS I

CAPUT X.

brethren in turns, from the book on the lectern. Between the lessons let three responsories be sung —two of them without a Gloria, but after the third let the reader say the Gloria: and as soon as he begins it, let all rise from their seats out of honour and reverence to the Holy Trinity. Let the divinely inspired books, both of the Old and New Testaments, be read at the Night-Office, and also the commentaries upon them written by the most renowned, orthodox and Catholic Fathers. After these three lessons with their responsories, let six more Psalms follow, to be sung with an Alleluia. Then let a lesson from the Apostle be said by heart, with a verse and the petition of the Litany, that is, Kyrie eleison. And so let the Night-Office come to an end.

CHAPTER X

# How the Night-Office is to be said in Summer time

eae ROM Easter to the first of 1 Feb. | November let the same number 13 Gen of Psalms be recited as prescribed above; only that no lessons are to be read from the book, on account of the shortness of the night: but instead of those three lessons let

one from the Old Testament be said by heart,





followed by a short responsory, and the rest as before laid down; so that never less than twelve Psalms, not counting the third and ninety-fourth, be said at the Night-Office.

CHAPTER XI

# How the Night-Office is to be said on Sundays

SEIN Sunday let the brethren rise 13 Feb. =!

earlier for the Night-Office, 14 Oct. which is to be arranged as follows. When six Psalms and a versicle have been sung (as already prescribed), all being seated in order in their stalls, let four lessons with their responsories be read from the book, as before: and to the last responsory only let the reader add a Gloria, all reverently rising as soon as he begins it. After the lessons let six more Psalms follow in order, with their antiphons and versicle as before ; and then let four more lessons, with their responsories, be read in the same way as the former. Next let three canticles from the Prophets be said, as the Abbot shall appoint, which canticles are to be sung with an Alleluia. After the versicle, and the blessing given by the Abbot, let four more lessons from the New Testament be read as before:

and at the end of the fourth responsory, let the

62 Reaufa S, Benedictt

Gute of at. Benedict 63

Abbot begin the hymn, Te oe ee After the hymn, let the Abbot read the lesson from the Gospel, while all stand in awe and reverence. The Gospel being ended, let all answer Amen. Then let the Abbot go on with the hymn, Te decet laus ; and after the blessing hath been given,* let them begin Lauds. This order for the Night-Office is always to be observed on Sunday, alike in summer and in winter, unless perchance (which God forbid) | they rise too late, in which case the lessons or responsories must be somewhat shortened.+ Let all care, however, be taken that this do not happen ; but if it should, let him, through whose neglect it hath come to pass, make satisfaction for it in the oratory.

CHAPTER XII

# How the Solemn Office of Lauds is to be said

ait Lauds on Sunday let the sixty- “4 Feb. sixth Psalm first be said straight 15 5 Oct. BNE on+ without an antiphon. After this sees tet the fifticth Psalm be said, with an Alleluia, and then the hundred and seventeenth and the sixty-second. Then the Benedicite and Psalms of praise,g a lesson from the Apocalypse, said by heart, a responsory, a hymn, a versicle, a canticle out of the Gospel, and the Litany, and so end,

64 Reagufa S. Benedicti

Plane agenda Matutina, vel Vespertina 16 Feb. non transeant aliquando, nisi ultimo per tee ordinem Oratio Dominica, omnibus audientibus,

CHAPTER XIII

# How Lauds are to be said on Week-days

CSEREN week-days let Lauds be cele- 15 Feb: JJ brated in manner following. Let one the sixty-sixth Psalm be said without an antiphon, as on Sundays, and somewhat slowly, in order that all may be in time for the fiftieth, which is to be said with an antiphon. After this let two other Psalms be said according to custom ; that is, on Monday, the fifth and thirtyfifth : on Tuesday, the forty-second and fifty-sixth : on Wednesday, the sixty-third and sixty-fourth: on Thursday, the eighty-seventh and eighty-ninth: on Priday, the seventy-fifth and ninety-first : and on Saturday, the hundred and forty-second and the Canticle from Deuteronomy, which must be divided into two Gloria's. But on the other days let canticles from the prophets be said, each on its proper day, according to the practice of the Roman Church. Then let the psalms of praise follow, and after them a lesson from the Apostle, to be said by heart, a responsory, a hymn, a versicle, a canticle out of the Gospel, the Litany, and so conclude.

The office of Lauds and Vespers, how- + Feb. ever, must never conclude without the + Got. Lord's Prayer being said aloud by the Superior, so

66 Regufa S, Benedicti

CAPUT XIV.

* Note H.—Scandalorum spinas.

that all may hear it, on account of the thorns of scandal * which are wont to arise; so that the brethren, by the covenant which they make in that prayer when they say 'Forgive us as we forgive, " may cleanse themselves of such faults. But at the other Offices let the last part only of the prayer be said aloud, so that all may answer: " But deliver us from evil."

CHAPTER XIV

# How the Night-Office is to be said on Saints'-days

pemeeyIN the Festivals of Saints, and all 17 Feb. Wi other solemnites, let the Office 3 ee be ordered as we have prescribed for Sundays : except that the Psalms, antiphons, and lessons suitable to the day are to be said. Their number, however, shall remain as we have appointed above.

CHAPTER XV

# At what times of the year Alleluia is to be said

Ae ROM the holy Feast of Easter 18 Feb.

until Pentecost, without inter- 19 Oct. ruption, let Alleluia be said both with the Psalms and the responsories. From Pentecost until the beginning of Lent, it is

68 Regula S. Benedicti

1B) laudem dixi tibi. [Ps. cxviii, 29 0c. 164.] Qui septenarius sacratus numerus a nobis sic implebitur, si Matutini,

* In the third nocturn of the Night-Office,

to be said at the Night-Office with the six latter Psalms only. But on every Sunday out of Lent let the Canticles," Lauds, Prime, Tierce, Sext and None be said with Alleluia: Vespers, however, with an antiphon. The responses are never to be said with Alleluia, except from Easter to Pentecost.

CHAPTER XVI

# How the Work of God is to be done in the day-time

ai the prophet saith :* Seven times 19 Feb. in the day have I given praise to Oc Thee.” And we shall observe this sacred number of seven if, at the times of Lauds, Prime, Tierce, Sext, None, Vespers arid Compline, we fulfil the duties of our service. For it was of these hours of the day that he said: « Seven times in the day have I given praise to Thee”; just as the same prophet saith of the night watches: ‘‘ At midnight I arose to give Thee praise.” At these times, therefore, let us sing the praises of our Creator for the judgments of His justice : that is, at Lauds, Prime, Tierce, Sext, None, Vespers and Compline ; and at night let us arise to praise Him,

70 Regufa J. Benedicti

CAPUT XVII.

CHAPTER XVII

# How many Psalms are to be sung at these Hours

eel have now disposed the order of 20 Hes the psalmody for the Night- 2: Oct.

Office and for Lauds; let us proceed to arrange for the remaining Hours. At Prime, let three Psalms be said, separately and not under one Gloria. The hymn at this Hour is to follow the verse, Deus in adjutorium, before the Psalms be begun. Then, at the end of the three Psalms, let one lesson be said, with a versicle, the Kyrie eleison, and the Collect.« Tierce, Sext, and None are to be recited in the same way, that is, the Verse, the hymn proper to each hour, three Psalms, the lesson and versicle, Kyrie eleison, with the Collect. If the community be large, let the Psalms be sung with antiphons ; but if small, let them be sung straight forward.t Let the Vesper Office consist of four Psalms with antiphons: after the Psalms a lesson is to be recited ; then a responsory, a hymn and versicle, the canticle from the Gospel, the Litany and Lord’s Prayer, and finally the Collect. Let Compline consist of the recitation of three Psalms, to be said straight on without antiphons ; then the hymn for that Hour, one lesson, the versicle, Kyrie eleison, the blessing and the Collect.

72 Regufa §. Benedictt

semper a vigesimo incipiatur.

CHAPTER XVIII

# In what order the Psalms are to be said

meee | RST of all let this verse be said: 2: Feb. | ""O God, come to my assistance; 22 Gen O Lord, make haste to help me," and the Gloria, followed by the Hymn proper to each Hour. At Prime on Sunday four parts of the hundred and eighteenth Psalm are to be said. At the other Hours, that is, Tierce, Sext, and None, let three parts of the same Psalm be said. At Prime on Monday let three Psalms be said, namely the first, second and sixth; and so in the same way every day until Sunday let three Psalms be said at Prime in order, up to the nineteenth ; the ninth and the seventeenth, however, being divided into two Gloria's. It will thus come about that at the Night-Office on Sunday we shall always begin with the twentieth Psalm.

At Tierce, Sext and None on Monday are 2 Feb. to be said the nine remaining parts of the bee hundred and eighteenth Psalm, three parts at each Hour. This Psalm having thus been said through in two days, that is Sunday and Monday, let the

nine Psalms from the hundred and nineteenth to

Regufa S. Benedicti

the hundred and twenty-second be said on Tuesday at Tierce, Sext and None—three at each Hour. And these Psalms are to repeated at the same Hours every day until Sunday; the arrangement, moreover, of hymns, lessons and versicles remaining the same throughout, so as always to begin on Sunday from the hundred and eighteenth Psalm.

Vespers are to be sung every day with 23 Feb. four Psalms. And let these begin from the a tee hundred and ninth, and go on to the hundred and forty-seventh, omitting those of their number which are set apart for other Hours—that is, from the hundred and seventeenth to the hundred and twenty-seventh, the hundred and thirty third, and the hundred and forty-second. All the rest are to be said at Vespers. And as there are three Psalms wanting, let those of the aforesaid number which are somewhat long be divided, namely the hundred and thirty-eighth, the hundred and forty-third, and the hundred and forty-fourth. But let the hundred and sixteenth, as it is short, be joined to the hundred and fifteenth.

The order of the Psalms at Vespers being thus disposed, let the rest, that is the lessons, responses, hymns, verses, and canticles, be said as already laid down. At Compline the same Psalms are to be repeated every day: namely the fourth, ninetieth, and hundred and thirty-third.

76 Beguta ak Benedict

si fuerit

lis ; alias

25 unii

The order of psalmody for the Day-Hours a4, Feb,

b being now arranged let all the remaining oe i

Psalms be equally distributed among the notit eo seven Night-Offices, dividing the longer os Psalms among them, and assigning twelve to es fy each night. Above all, we recommend that 25 bet

if this arrangement of the Psalms be displeasing to any one, he should, if he think fit, order it otherwise ; taking care in any case that the whole Psalter of a hundred and fifty Psalms be recited every week, and always begun afresh at the Night-Office on Sunday. For those monks would shew themselves very slothful in the divine service who said in the course of a week less than the entire Psalter, with the usual canticles; since we read that our holy fathers resolutely performed in a single day what I pray we tepid monks may achieve in a whole — week.

CHAPTER XIX

# Of the Discipline of saying the Divine Office

#E believe that the Divine presence 24 Feb. is everywhere, and that the eyes ayha of the Lorp behold the good and the evil in every place. Especially should we believe this, without any doubt, when we are

assisting at the Work of God, Let us, then, ever



remember what the prophet saith: “ Serve the Lorp in fear” ; and again, “ Sing ye wisely” ; and, “ In the sight of the angels I will sing praises unto Thee.” Therefore let us consider how we ought to behave ourselves in the presence of God and of His angels, and so assist at the Divine Office, that our mind and our voice may accord together.

CHAPTER XX

# Of Reverence at Prayer

=a, when we wish to make any 25 Feb. 4 27 June request to men in power, we 27 Oct. presume not to do so except with humility and reverence ; how much more ought we with all lowliness and purity of devotion to offer our supplications to the Lorp God of all things? And let us remember that not for our much speaking, but for our purity of heart and tears of compunction shall we be heard. Our prayer, therefore, ought to be short and pure, except it be perchance prolonged by the inspiration of Divine Grace. But let prayer made in common always be short: and at the signal given by the

Superior, let all rise together,

80 Regufa S. Benedicti

YHINGULI per singula lecta dor- 27 Feb. miant. Lectisternia pro modo 29 bee conversationis, secundum dispensationem Abbatis sui, accipiant. Si

* Note L,,—/ sxo loco.

CHAPTER XXI

# Of the Deans of the Monastery

4 28 June let there be chosen from it cer- 28 Oct.

eae AHOULD the community be large, 26 Feb. tain brethren of good repute and holy life, and appointed Deans. Let them carefully direct their deaneries in all things according to the commandments of God and the will of their Abbot. And let such men be chosen Deans as the Abbot may safely trust to share his burdens : let them not be chosen according to order, but for the merit of their lives and for their wisdom and learning. And should any one of them, being puffed up with pride, be found worthy of blame, and after being thrice corrected, refuse to amend, let him be deposed, and one who is worthy put in his place. And we order the same to be done with regard to the Prior.

CHAPTER XXII

# How the Monks are to Sleep

p= paET them sleep each one in a 27 Feb. 1 | separate bed, receiving bedding 29 bat suitable to their manner of life, as the Abbot shall appoint. If possible, let

all sleep in one place:”* but if the number do not



permit of this, let them repose by tens or twenties with the seniors who have charge of them. Let a candle burn constantly in the cell until morning. Let them sleep clothed, and girded with belts or cords—but not with knives at their sides, lest perchance they wound themselves in their sleep—and thus be always ready, so that when the signal is given they may rise without delay, and hasten each to forestall the other in going to the Work of God, yet with all gravity and modesty. Let not the younger brethren have their beds by themselves, but among those of the seniors. And when they. rise for the Work of God, let them gently encourage one another, because of the excuses of the drowsy.

CHAPTER XXIII

# Of Excommunication for Offences

p= any brother shall be found con- 28 Feb. Rf Ys rt : 3 30 June tumacious, or disobedient, or 30 Oct. proud, or a murmurer, or in any way transgressing the Holy Rule, and contemning the orders of his seniors ; let him, according to our Lorp’s commandment, be once or twice privately admonished by his elders. If he do not

amend, let him be rebuked in public before all.

84 Regufa 3S. Benedicti

Si vero neque sic correxerit, si intelligit qualis poena sit, excommunicationi subjaceat. Sin autem improbus est, vindictze corporali subdatur.

But if even then he do not correct himself, let him be subjected to excommunication, provided that he understand the nature of the punishment. Should he, however, prove incorrigible, let him undergo corporal chastisement.

CHAPTER XXIV

# What the measure of Excommunication should be

=i t1E measure of excommunication «x Mar. or chastisement should be meted 3: bet out according to the gravity of the offence, the estimation of which shall be left to the judgment of the Abbot. If any brother be found guilty of lighter faults, let him be excluded from the common table. And this shall be the rule for one so deprived: he shall intone neither Psalm nor antiphon in the Oratory, nor shall he read a lesson, until he have made satisfaction. Let him take his meals alone, after those of the brethren ; so that if, for example, the brethren eat at the sixth hour, let him eat at the ninth: if they eat at the ninth, let him eat in the evening, until by proper satisfaction he obtain pardon.

86 Regula S. Benedicti

Hie aess |)

CAPUT XXVI.

dictam.

CHAPTER XXV

# Of graver Faults

SaieT that brother who is found 2 Mar. 1 guilty of a more grievous offence re be excluded both from the table and. from the Oratory, and let none of the brethren consort with him or speak to him. Let him be alone at the work enjoined him, and continue in penance and sorrow, remembering that dreadful sentence of the Apostle, ‘‘ That such a one is delivered over to Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that his spirit may be saved in the day of the Lorp.” Let him take his portion of food alone, in the measure and at the time that the Abbot shall think best for him. Let none of those who pass by

bless him, nor the food that is given him.

CHAPTER XXVI

# Of those who, without leave of the Abbot, consort with the Excommunicate

RF any brother presume without 3 Mar. a Vi) the Abbot’s leave to hold any he os || intercourse whatever with an excommunicated brother, or to speak with him, or to send him a message, let him incur the same punishment of excommunication.

88 Regufa S. Benedictt

FIRION

CAPUT XXVII.

* Note M.—Sympectas.

CHAPTER XXVII

# How careful the Abbot should be of the Excommunicate

ET the Abbot shew all care and 4 Mar. solicitude towards the offending hon brethren, for ‘‘they that are whole need not a physician, but they that are sick.” To which end he ought, as a wise physician, to use every means in his power, sending some brethren of mature years and wisdom,” who may, as it were secretly, console the wavering brother, and induce him to make humble satisfaction. Let them comfort him, that he be not overwhelmed by excess of sorrow; but as the Apostle saith, ‘ Let charity be strengthened towards him,’ and let all pray for him. For the Abbot is bound to use the greatest care, and to strive with all possible pru- « dence and zeal, not to lose any one of the sheep committed to him. He must know that he hath undertaken the charge of weakly souls, and not a tyranny over the strong; and let him fear the threat of the prophet, through whom God saith: ‘‘ What ye saw to be fat that ye took to yourselves, and what was diseased ye cast away.’ Let him imitate the loving example of the Good Shepherd, who, leaving the ninety and nine sheep on the mountains, went to seek one which had gone astray, on whose weakness He had such compassion that

90 : Regufa S. Benedicti

CAPUT XXVIII.

De HIS, QUI S#PIUS CORRECTI NON © EMENDAVERINT.

He vouchsafed to lay it on His own sacred shoulders and so bring it back to the flock.

CHAPTER XXVIII

# Of those who, being often corrected, do not amend

rese=sssa any brother who has been fre- quae Wa TiN uly SN a quently corrected for some fault, 4 Nov. <4; or even excommunicated, do not amend

let a more severe chastisement be applied: that is, let the punishment of stripes be administered to him. But if even then he do not correct himself, or perchance (which God forbid), puffed up with pride, even wish to defend his deeds: then let the Abbot act like a wise physician. If he hath applied fomentations and the unction of his admonitions, the medicine of the Holy Scriptures, and the last remedy of excommunication or corporal chastisement, and if he see that his labours are of no avail, let him add what is still more powerful— his own prayers and those of all the brethren for him, that God, Who is all-powerful, may work the cure of the sick brother. But if he be not healed even by this means, then at length let the Abbot use the sword of separation, as the Apostle saith: “ Put away the evil one from you.” And again: “If the faithless one depart, let him depart,’’ lest one diseased sheep should taint the whole flock.

Regufa S. Benedicti

CAPUT XXIX.

CHAPTER XXIX

# Whether the Brethren who leave the Monastery are to be received again

out of the Monastery, ‘be willing to return, let him first undertake to amend entirely the fault for which he went away; and

then let him be received back into the lowest place, that thus his humility may be tried. Should he again depart, let him be taken back until the third time: knowing that after this all return will be denied to him.

CHAPTER XXX

# How the younger boys are to be corrected

sege|VERY age and understanding ; Mar.

( : 7 July should have its proper measure 6 Nov. of discipline. As often, therefore, as boys, or others under age, or unable to understand the greatness of the penalty of excommunication, commit faults, let them be punished by severe fasting or sharp stripes, in order that they may be cured.

94 Regufa S. Benedictt

CAPUT XXXI.

MJELLERARIUS Monasterii eliga- 8 Mar.

CHAPTER XXXI

# What kind of man the Cellarer of the Monastery is to be

aT there be chosen out of the 8 Mar. community, as Cellarer of the eke Monastery, a man wise and of mature character, temperate, not a great eater, not haughty, nor headstrong, nor arrogant, not slothful, nor wasteful, but a God-fearing man, who may be like a father to the whole community. Let him have the care of everything, but do nothing « without leave of the Abbot. Let him take heed to what is commanded him, and not sadden his brethren. If a brother ask him for anything unreasonably, let him not treat him with contempt and so grieve him, but reasonably and with all humility refuse what he asks for amiss. Let him be watchful over his own soul, remembering always that saying of the Apostle, that “he that hath ministered well, purchaseth to himself a good degree.” Let him have especial care of the sick, of the children, of guests and of the poor, knowing without doubt that he will have to render an account of all these on the Day of Judgment. Let him look upon all the vessels and goods of the Monastery as though they were the consecrated vessels of the

96 Regufa 3. Benedicti

Nihil ducat negligendum: neque avaritiz studeat, neque prodigus sit, et exstirpator substantiz Monasterii; sed omnia mensurate faciat, et secundum jussionem Abbatis sui.

* Note N—Szxe typo.

altar. Let him not think that he may neglect anything: let him not be given to covetousness, nor wasteful, nor a squanderer of the goods of the Monastery; but do all things in proper measure, and according to the bidding of his Abbot.

Let him above all things have humility; 9 Mar. and to him on whom he hath nothing else to 8 Nov. bestow, let him give at least a kind answer, as it is written: ‘‘A good word is above the best gift.” Let him have under his care all that the Abbot may enjoin him, and presume not to meddle with what is forbidden him. Let him distribute to the brethren their appointed allowance of food, without arrogance * or delay, that they be not scandalised : mindful of what the Word of God declareth him to deserve, who “shall scandalise one of these little ones”: namely, ‘‘ that a mill-stone be hanged about his neck and that he be drowned in the depths of the sea.” If the community be large, let helpers be given to him, by whose aid he may with peace of mind discharge the office committed to him. Let such things as are necessary be given and asked for at befitting times, that no one may be troubled nor grieved in the house of God.

98 Regufa S, Benedicti

CAPUT XXXII.

CHAPTER XXXII

# Of the Iron Tools, and Property of the Monastery

VALET the Abbot appoint brethren, 10 Mar. 7 on whose manner of life and oh. character he can rely, to the charge of the iron tools, clothes, and other property of the Monastery ; and let him consign to their care, as he shall think fit, the things to be kept and collected after use. Of these let the Abbot keep a list, so that as the brethren in turn succeed: to different employments, he may know what he giveth and receiveth back. If any one treat the property of the Monastery in a slovenly or negligent manner, let him be corrected ; and if he do not amend, let him be subjected to the discipline of the Rule.

CHAPTER XXXIII

# Whether Monks ought to have anything of their own

3 a Pee vice of private ownership is nx aa above all to be cut off from the 10 Nov. Monastery by the roots. Let none presume to give or receive anything without leave of the Abbot, nor to keep anything



CAPUT XXXIV.

as their own, either book or writing-tablet or pen, or anything whatsoever ; since they are permitted to have neither body nor will in their own power. But all that is necessary they may hope to receive from the father of the Monastery: nor are they. allowed to keep anything which the Abbot has not given, or at least permitted them to have. Let all things be common to all, as it is written: ‘ Neither did any one say that aught which he possessed was his own.” But if any one shall be found to indulge in this most baneful vice, and after one or two admonitions do not amend, let him be subjected to correction.

CHAPTER XXXIV

# Whether all ought alike to receive what is needful

=eea\S it is written: ‘ Distribution was 12 Mar.

made to every man, according 1 Nov, as he had need.” Herein we do not

say that there should be respecting of persons—God forbid—but consideration for infirmities. Let him, therefore, that hath need of less give thanks to God, and not be grieved ; and let him who requireth more be humbled for his infirmity, and not made proud by the kindness

102 Reagufa S. Benedictt

CAPUT XXXV.

De SEPTIMANARIIS COQUINA.

shewn to him: and so all the members of the family shall be at peace. Above all, let not the evil of murmuring shew itself by the slightest word or sign on any account whatsoever. If any one be found guilty herein, let him be subjected to very severe punishment.

CHAPTER XXXV

# Of the Weekly Servers in the Kitchen

aET the brethren wait on one 13 Mar. _ ; 13 July another in turn, so that none be 12 Nov; excused from the work of the kitchen, except he be prevented by sickness or by some more necessary enployment : for thus is gained a greater reward and an increase of charity. But let assistance be given to the weak, that they _ may not do their work with sadness: and let all | have help according to the number of the community and the situation of the place. If the community be large, let the Cellarer be excused from work in the kitchen, and also those, as already mentioned, who are occupied in more urgent business. Let the rest serve each other in turn with all charity. Let him who endeth his week in the

104 Regufa J. Genedicti

kitchen, make all things clean on Saturday, and wash the towels wherewith the brethren dry their hands and feet. Let both him who goeth out and him who is coming in wash the feet of all. Let him hand over to the Cellarer the vessels of his office, clean and whole; and let the Cellarer deliver the same to him who entereth, that he may know what he giveth and what he receiveth.

Let the weekly servers take each a cup 14 Mar. of drink and a piece of bread over and above 3 Nov. the appointed portion, one hour before the time for refection, that so they may serve their brethren, when the hour cometh, without murmuring or great labour. On solemn days, however, let them forbear until after Mass.* On Sunday, as soon as Lauds are ended, let both the incoming and the outgoing servers fall on their knees before all, in the Oratory, and ask their prayers. Let him who endeth his week, say this verse: ‘‘ Blessed art Thou, Lorp God, Who hast helped me and comforted me ;” which being thrice repeated, he shall receive the blessing.+ Let him that beginneth his week follow, and say: “O God, come to my assistance : O Lorp, make haste to help me.” Let this likewise be thrice repeated by all ; and having received the blessing, let him enter on his office.

106 Regufa S. Benedicti

CAPUT XXXVI.

De INFIRMIS FPRATRIBUS.

CHAPTER XXXVI

# Of the Sick Brethren

things care is to be had of the 14 5 Joly

sick, that they be served in very deed as Christ Himself, for He hath said : ‘‘ ] was sick, and ye visited Me.” And, ‘‘ What ye have done unto one of these little ones, ye have done unto Me.’ And let the sick themselves remember that they are served for the honour of God, and not grieve the brethren who serve them by unnecessary demands. Yet must they be patiently borne with, because from such as these is gained a more abundant reward. Let it be therefore the Abbot’s greatest care that they suffer no neglect. And let a cell be set apart by itself for the sick brethren, and one who is God-fearing, diligent, and careful, be appointed to serve them. Let the use of baths be allowed to the sick as often as may be expedient ; but to those who are well, and especially to the young, let it be granted more seldom. Let the use of flesh meat also be permitted to the sick and to those that are very weakly, for their recovery: but when they are restored to health, let all abstain from meat in the accustomed manner. The Abbot must take all possible care that the sick be not neglected by the

108 Regufa J. Benedicti

Fa lCET ipsa natura humana trahatur 16 ies y i : 5 3 K 16 Julii ad miserlcordiam in his zetatibus, 15 Nov.

cas.

Cellarer or servers : because whatever is done amiss by his disciples is laid to his charge.

CHAPTER XXXVII

# Of Old Men and Children

=——ra1. THOUGH human nature is of 16 Mar. itself drawn to feel pity for these = Nae two times of life, namely old age and infancy, yet the authority of the Rule

should also provide for them. Let their weakness

be always taken into account, and the strictness of the Rule respecting food be by no means kept in their regard ; but let a kind consideration be shewen for them, and let them eat before the regular

hours.

CHAPTER XXXVIII

# Of the Weekly Reader

ssaQQ,EADING must not be wanting +7 Mar.

M while the brethren eat at table ; 6 Nov. nor let any one who may chance to have taken up the book presume to

read, but let him who is to read throughout the

110 Regufa S. Benedieti

week begin upon the Sunday. After Mass and Communion, let him ask all to pray for him, that God may keep from him the spirit of pride. And let this verse be said thrice in the Oratory, he himself beginning it: “O Lorp, Thou shalt open my lips, and my mouth shall declare Thy praise.” And so, having received the blessing, let him enter on his reading. The greatest silence must be kept at table, so that no whispering may be heard there, nor any voice except that of him who readeth. And whatever is necessary for food or drink let the brethren so minister to each other, that no one need ask for anything: but should anything be wanted, let it be asked for by a sign rather than by the voice. And let no one presume to put any questions there, either about the reading or about anything else, lest it should give occasion for talking: unless perchance the Superior should wish to say a few words for the edification of the brethren. Let the brother who is reader for the week take a little bread and wine before he begin to read, on account of the Holy Communion,” and lest it be hard for him to fast so long. Afterwards let him take his meal with the weekly cooks and other servers. The brethren are not to read or sing according to their order, but such et as may edify the hearers.

112 Regula S. Benedictt

duo pulmentaria, propter diversorum

CHAPTER XXXIX

# Of the Measure of Food

esas think it sufficient for the daily : ae i meal, whether at the sixth or Nav

the ninth hour, that there be at all

seasons of the year two dishes of cooked food, because of the weakness of different | people; so that he who perchance cannot eat of the one, may make his meal of the other. Let two dishes, then, suffice for ali the brethren; and if there be any fruit or young vegetables, let a third be added. Let one pound weight of bread suffice for the day, whether there be but one meal, or both dinner and supper. If they are to sup, let a third part of the pound be kept back by the Cellarer, and given to them for supper. If, however, their work chance to have been hard, it shall be in the Abbot’s power, if he think fit, to make some addition, avoiding above everything, all surfeiting, that the monks be not overtaken by indigestion. For there is nothing so adverse to a Christian as gluttony, according to the words of our Lorp: “ See that your hearts be not overcharged with surfeiting.” And let not the same quantity be allotted to children of tender years, but less than to their elders, moderation being observed in every case. Let every one abstain altogether from the flesh of four-footed animals, except the very weak and the sick.

114 Regufa S. Benedicti

=| NUSQUISQUE proprium habet 10 Mar.

CHAPTER XL

# Of the Measure of Drink

re,VERY one hath his proper gift 19 Mar. I from God, one after this manner, x8 Nee another after that. And therefore it is with some misgiving that we appoint the measure of other men’s living. Yet considering the infirmity of the weak, we think that one pint of wine a day is sufficient for each: but let those to whom God gives the endurance of abstinence know that they shall have their proper reward. If, however the situation of the place, the work, or the heat of summer require more, let it be in the power of the Superior to grant it; taking care in every thing that surfeit or drunkenness creep notin. And although we read that wine ought by no means to

be the drink of monks, yet since in our times monks - cannot be persuaded of this, let us at least agree not to drink to satiety, but sparingly : because ‘‘ wine maketh even the wise to fall away.”’ But where the necessity of the place alloweth not even the aforesaid measure, but much less, or none at all, let those who dwell there bless God and not murmur. This above all we admonish, that there be no murmuring among them,

116 Regufa S. Benedicti

CHAPTER XLI

# At what Hours the Brethren are to take their Meals

ene) OM Holy Easter until Pentecost 20 Mar. | let the brethren dine at the sixth 1 toy hour, and sup in the evening. But from Pentecost throughout the summer (unless they have to work in the the fields, or are harassed by excessive heat) let them fast on Wednesdays and Pridays until the ninth hour, but on other days dine at the sixth. Should they have field labour, or should the heat of the summer be very great, they must always take their dinner at the sixth hour. Let the Abbot provide for this, and let him so arrange and dispose all things, that souls may be saved, and that the brethren may do what they have to do without just cause for murmuring. From the fourteenth of September until the beginning of Lent let them always dine at the ninth hour ; and during Lent, until Easter, in the evening. And let the hour of the evening meal be so ordered that they have no need of a lamp while eating, but let all be over while it is yet daylight. At all times, whether of dinner or supper, let the hour be so arranged that everything be done by daylight.

118 Regula S. Benedictt

CHAPTER XLII

# That no one may speak after Compline

Z P=SONKS should love silence at all 2x Mar. | times, but especially during the so Now hours of the night. Therefore, on all days, whether of fasting or otherwise, let them sit down all together as soon as they have risen from supper (if it be not a fast-day) and let one of them read the “ Conferences” [of Cassian], or the lives of the Fathers, or something else which may edify the hearers. Not, however, Heptateuch, nor the Books of Kings: for it will not profit those of weak understanding to hear those parts of Scripture at that hour:* they may, however, be read at other times. If it be a fast-day, then a short time after Vespers let them assemble for the reading of the Conferences, as we have said ; four or five pages being read, or as much as time alloweth, so that during the reading all may gather together, even those who may have been occupied in some work enjoined them. Everyone, then, being assembled, let them say Compline ; and when that is finished, let none be allowed to speak to any one. And if any one be found to evade this rule of silence, let him be subjected to severe punishment ; unless the presence of guests should make it necessary, or the

120 Regufa 3. Benedictt

CAPUT XLII.

Abbot should chance to give any command. Yet, even then, let it be done with the utmost gravity and moderation.

CHAPTER XLIII

# Of those who come late to the Work of God, or to table

“ar the hour of Divine Office, as 22 Mar. 4} soon as the signal is heard, let £ ao every one, leaving whatever he had in hand, hasten to the Oratory with all

speed, and yet with seriousness, so that no occasion

be given for levity.

Let. nothing, then, be preferred to the Work of God, And should any one come to the Night-Office after the Gloria of the ninety-fourth Psalm (which for this reason we wish to be said very slowly and protractedly), let him not stand in his order in the choir, but last of all, or in the place set apart by the Abbot for the negligent, so that he may be seen by him and by all, until, the work of God being ended, he have made satisfaction by public penance. The reason why we have judged it fitting for them to stand in the last place, or apart, is that, being seen of all, they may amend for very shame. For, if they were to remain outside the Oratory, some one perchance would return to his place and go to sleep, or at all events would sit down outside, and

122 Regufa S, Benedicti

tionem congruam.

give himself to idle talk, and thus an occasion would be given to the evil one. Let him therefore enter, that he may not lose the whole, and may amend for the future. At the day Hours, let him who cometh to the Work of God after the Verse,* and the Gloria of the first Psalm which followeth it, stand in the last place, as ordered above, and not presume to join with the choir in the Divine Office, until he hath made satisfaction: unless perchance, the Abbot shall permit him so to do, on condition, however, that he afterwards do penance.

If any one, through his own negligence 23 Mar. and fault, come not to table before the Verse, a Ney, so that all may say this and the prayer together, and together sit down to table, let him be once or twice corrected. If after this he do not amend let him not be admitted to share in the common table, but be separated from the companionship of all, and eat alone, his portion of wine being taken from him, until he hath made satisfaction and amends. Let him be punished in like manner, who is not present also at the Verse which is said after meals. And let no one presume to take food or drink before or after the appointed hour: but should a brother be offered anything by the Superior, and refuse to take it, if he afterwards desire either what he before refused, or anything else, he shall receive nothing whatever, until he hath made proper satisfaction.

124 Regula S. Benerdieti

CAPUT XLIV.

DE HIS QUI EXCOMMUNICANTUR, QUOMODO SATISFACIANT.

CHAPTER XLIV

# Of those who are excommunicated, how they are to make satisfaction

‘a1ET him, who for graver offences 24 Mar. is excommunicated from the 23 Nov. Oratory and the table, prostrate himself at the door of the Oratory, saying nothing, at the hour when the Work of God is being performed : lying prone, with his face upon the ground, at the feet of all who go out from the Oratory. Let him continue to do this until the Abbot judge that he hath made satisfaction ; and then, coming at the Abbot’s bidding, let him cast himself at his feet and at the feet of all, that they may pray for him. After this, if the Abbot so order, let him be received back into the choir, in such a place as he shall appoint: yet so, that he presume not to intone Psalm or lesson, or anything else, in the Oratory, unless the Abbot again command him. And at all the Hours, when the Work of God is ended, let him cast himself on the ground, in the place where he standeth, and so make satisfaction, until such time as the Abbot bid him cease therefrom. But let those, who for lighter faults are ex-

communicated only from the table, make satisfaction in the Oratory so long as the Abbot shall command, and continue so doing until he bless them and say it is enough.

126 Regufa 3. Benedicti

CAPUT XLV. DE HIS GUI FALLUNTUR IN ORATORIO.

CAPUT XLVI.

DE HIS QUI IN ALIIS QUIBUSLIBET REBUS DELINQUUNT.

CHAPTER XLV

# Of those who make mistakes in the Oratory

Seeesear any one make a mistake in the 25 Mar. Ge Tun 25 July recitation of Psalm, responsory, 24 Nov. S| antiphon, or lesson, and do not humble

mace himself by making satisfaction there before all, let him be subjected to severer punishment, as one who would not correct by humility what he did wrong through negligence. But children

for such faults are to be whipt.*

CHAPTER XLVI

# Of those who offend in any other matters

pcre cass

yee F any one, while at work in the 26 Mar. a Te kitchen or the cellar, in serving 251 es | the brethren, in the bakehouse or the garden, or at any other occupation or in any place whatever, commit any fault, or break or lose anything, or transgress in any other way, and do not come immediatly before the Abbot and community, and of himself confess and make satisfaction for his fault ; if it is made known by another, he shall be subjected to more severe correction. If, however, the guilt of his offence be hidden in his own soul, let him manifest it to the Abbot only, or to his spiritual seniors, who know how to heal their own wounds, and will not disclose or publish those of others.

128 Regula J. Benedictt

CHAPTER XLVII

# Of signifying the Hour for the Work of God

Prange yes T the announcing of the hour for 27 Mar. # «6the Work of God, both by day OR and night, be the Abbot’s care: either ———— by signifying it himself, or by entrusting the duty to such a careful brother, that ail things may be done at the appointed times. Let the Psalms and antiphons be intoned by those whose duty it is, each in his order, after the Abbot. Let no one presume to sing or to read except such as can so perform the office that the hearers may be edified. And let it be done with humility, gravity, and awe, and by those whom the Abbot hath appointed.

CHAPTER XLVIII

# Of the Daily Manual Labour

yea DILENESS is an enemy to the 28 Mar. x : soul; and hence at certain pe ee seasons the brethren ought to occupy themselves in the labour of their hands, and at others in holy reading. We think, therefore, that the times for each may be disposed as follows: from Easter to the first of October, let them, in going from Prime in the morning, labour

130 Regufa S. Benedicti

at whatever is required of them until about the fourth hour. From the fourth hour until near the | sixth let them apply themselves to reading. And : when they rise from table, after the sixth hour, let them rest on their beds in perfect silence ; or if any one perchance desire to read, let him do so in such a way as not to disturb any one else. Let None be said in good time, at about the middle of the eight hour ; and then let them again work at whatever has to be done, until Vespers. And if the needs of the place, or their poverty, oblige them to labour themselves at gathering in the crops, let them not be saddened thereat ; because then are they truly monks, when they live by the labour of their hands, as did our fathers and the Apostles, Yet let | all be done with moderation, on account of the fainthearted,

From the first of October to the be- 29 Mar. ginning of Lent, let them apply to reading 23 Nov. until the end of the second hour. Let Tierce be then said, and until the ninth hour let all labour at the work that is enjoined them. When the first signal for None is given, let every one break off from his work, and be ready as soon as the second signalissounded. After their meal, let them occupy themselves in their reading, or in learning the Psalms. During Lent, let them apply themselves to reading from morning until the end of the third

132 Regula Ss. Benedtctt

consideranda est.

hour, and then, until the end of the tenth, labour at whatever is enjoined them. And in these days of Lent let each one receive a book from the library, and read it all through in order. These books are to be given out at the beginning of Lent. Above all, let one or two seniors be appointed to go round the Monastery, at the hours when the brethren are engaged in reading, and see that there be no slothful brother giving himself to idleness or to foolish talk, and not applying himself to his reading, so that he is thus not only useless to himself, but a distraction to others. If such a one be found (which God forbid) let him be corrected once and a second time ; and if he do not amend, let him be subjected to the chastisement of the Rule, so that the rest may be afraid. And let not one brother associate with an

other at unseasonable hours.

On Sunday, let all occupy themselves in 30 Mar. reading, except those who have _ been 29 Noy. appointed to the various offices. But if any one should be so negligent and slothful, as to be either unwilling or unable to study or to read, let some task be given him to do, that

he be not idle. To brethren who are weak or delicate, let there be given such work or occupation as to prevent them either from being idle, or from being so oppressed by excessive labour as to be driven away. Their weakness must be taken into account by the Abbot.

134 Regufa S, Benedictt

CHAPTER XLIX

# Of the Observance of Lent

s=a.THOUGH the life of a monk 3: Mar, d ought at all times to have about 30 ie it a Lenten character, yet since few have strength enough for this, we exhort all, at least during the days of Lent, to keep themselves in all purity of life, and to wash away, during that holy season, the negligences of other times. This we shall worthily do, if we refrain from all sin, and give ourselves to prayer with tears, to holy reading, compunction of heart and abstinence. In these days, then, let us add something to our wonted service ; as private prayers, and abstinence from food and drink, so that every one of his own will may offer to God, with joy of the Holy Spirit, something beyond the measure appointed him: withholding from his body somewhat of his food, drink, and sleep, refraining from talking and mirth, and awaiting Holy Easter with the joy of spiritual longing. Let each one, however, make known to his Abbot what he offereth, and let it be done with his blessing and permission: because what is done without leave of the spiritual father shall be imputed to presumption and vain-glory, and merit no reward. Everything, therefore, is to be done with the approval of the Abbot.

136 Regula J. Benedictt

CAPUT L.

CAPUT LI.

CHAPTER L

# Of the Brethren who are working at a distance from the Oratory, or are on a journey

g4ET the brethren who are at work 1 Apr. at a great distance, or on a 1Dec. journey, and cannot come to _ the Oratory at the proper time (the Abbot judging such to be the case) perform the Work of God there where they are labouring, in godly fear, and on bended knees. In like manner, let not those who are sent on a journey allow the appointed Hours to pass by ; but, as far as they can, observe them by themselves, and not neglect to fulfil their obligation of divine service.

CHAPTER LI

# Of the Brethren who go not very far off

alERT not the brother who is sent out 2 Apr. ;| : 2 Aug. on any business, and hopeth to 2 Dec. return that same day to the Monastery, presume to eat while abroad, even although pressed by any one to do so, unless perchance he have been bidden by his Abbot. If he do otherwise, let him be excommunicated,

-138 Regula S. Benedictt

CAPUT LI.

De Oratorio MONASTERII.

CHAPTER LII

# Of the Oratory of the Monastery

“aiE,'T the Oratory be what it is called, 3 Apr.

a place of prayer: and let bee

nothing else be done, or kept there.* When the Work of God is ended, let all go out with the utmost silence, paying due reverence to God, so that a brother, who perchance wishes to pray by himself, may not be hindered by another’s misconduct. If any one desire to pray in private, let him go in quietly and pray, not with a loud voice, but with tears and fervour of heart. And let it not be permitted, as we have said, to remain in the Oratory when the Work of God is finished, except it be for a like purpose, lest hindrance be caused to others.

CHAPTER LIII

# Of receiving Guests

a@lET all guests that come be re- 4 Apr. ceived like Christ Himself, for 4 Dec. He will say: “I was a stranger and ye took Me in.” And let fitting honour

be shewn to all, especially to such as are of the

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household of the faith, and to strangers. When, therefore, a guest is announced, let him be met by the Superior or the brethren, with all due charity. Let them first pray together, and thus associate with one another in peace ; but the kiss of peace must not be offered until after prayer, on account of the delusions of the devil. In this salutation let all humility be shewn. At the arrival or departure of all guests, let Christ —who indeed is received in their persons—be adored in them, by bowing the head or even prostrating on the ground.

When the guests have been received, let them be led to prayer, and then let the Superior, or any one he may appoint, sit with them. The law of God is to be read before the guest for his edification ; and afterwards let all kindness be shewn him. The Superior may break his fast for sake of the guest, unless it happen to be a principal fast-day, which may not be broken. The brethren, however, shall observe their accustomed fasting. Let the Abbot pour water on the hands of the guests ; and himself, as well as the whole community, wash their feet ; after which let them say this verse: ‘‘We have received Thy mercy, O God, in the midst of Thy Temple.” Let special care be taken in the reception of the poor and of strangers, because in them Christ is more truly welcomed. For the very fear men have of the rich procures them honour.

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* Note T.—FPedita benedictione.

Let the kitchen for the Abbot and guests ; Apr. be apart by itself ; so that strangers, who ao are never wanting in a monastery, may not disturb the brethren by coming at unlooked-for hours. Let two brothers, who are well able to fulfil the duty, be placed in this kitchen for a year; and let help be afforded them as they require it, so that they may serve without murmuring. When they have not much to occupy them there, let them go forth to other work, wherever they may be bidden. And not only with regard to them, but in all the offices of the Monastery, let there be such consideration shewn, that when there is need of help it may be given them ; and that when they are without work, they do whatever they are commanded. Let the care of the guest-house, also, be entrusted to a brother whose soul is possessed with the fear of God: let there be sufficient beds prepared there and let the house of God be wisely governed by prudent men. Let no one, except he be bidden, on any account associate or converse with the guests. But if he chance to meet or to see them, after humbly saluting them, as we have said, and asking their blessing,* let him pass on, saying that he is not permitted to talk with a guest.

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CAPUT LIV.

SULLATENUS liceat monacho 6 Apr.

24 STIMENTA fratribus secundum , apr.

CHAPTER LIV

# Whether a Monk ought to receive letters or tokens

a Y no means let a monk be allowed ye to receive, either from his parents 6 Dec. or any one else, or from his brethren, letters, tokens,* or any gifts whatsoever, or to give them to others, without permission of the Abbot. And if anything be sent to him, even by his parents, let him not presume to receive it until it hath been made known to the Abbot. But even if the Abbot order it to be received, it shall be in his power to bid it be given to whom he pleaseth ; and let not the brother to whom it may have been sent be grieved, lest occasion be given to the devil. Should any one, however, presume to act otherwise, let him be subjected to the discipline of the Rule.

CHAPTER LV

# Of the Clothes and Shoes of the Brethren

ra ET clothing be given to the Pape @| brethren suitable to the nature 7 Dec. and the climate of the place where they live : for in cold countries more is required, in warm countries less. This must there-

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fore be considered by the Abbot. We think, however, that in temperate climates a cowl and a tunic should suffice for each monk : the cowl to be of thick stuff in winter, but in summer something worn or thin : likewise a scapular for work, and shoes and stockings to cover their feet. And let not the monks complain of the colour or coarseness of these things, but let them be such as can be got in the country where they live, or can be bought most cheaply.

Let the Abbot be careful about the size of the garments, that they be not too short for those who wear them, but of the proper length. When they receive new clothes let them always give up the old ones at once, to be put by in the wardrobe for the poor. For it is sufficient for a monk to have two tunics and two cowls for wearing at night, and also for washing : whatever is over and above this is super- ° fluous, and ought to be cut off. In the same way, let them give up their shoes, and whatever else is worn out, when they receive new ones. Let those who are sent on a journey receive drawers from the wardrobe, and on their return restore them washed. Their cowls and tunics also, which are to be a little better than those they ordinarily wear, let them receive from the wardrobe when setting out on their journey, and give them back on their return.

For their bedding let a straw mattress, ee blanket, coverlet, and pillow suffice. These 8 Dec.

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cogitet.

beds must be frequently inspected by the Abbot, to see if any private property be discovered therein. And if any one should be found to have anything which he hath not received from the Abbot, let him be subjected to the most severe discipline. In order that this vice of private ownership may be rooted out entirely, let the Abbot supply them with all necessaries: that is, a cowl, tunic, shoes, stockings, girdle, knife, pen, needle, handkerchief, and tablets ; so that all plea of wanting anything may be taken away. Yet let the Abbot always be mindful of those words of the Acts of the Apostles : “ Distribution was made to every one, according as he had need.’”’ Let him, therefore, consider the infirmities of such as are in want, and not the ill-will of the envious. Nevertheless, in all his judgments, let him think of the retribution of God.

CHAPTER LVI

# Of the Abbot's Table

ag ava ET the table of the Abbot be ohne,

Wai) always with the guests and 9 Dec.

strangers. But as often as there are few guests, it shall be in his power to invite any of the brethren. Let him take care, however, always to leave one or two seniors with the brethren for the sake of discipline.

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CAPUT LVII.

DE AVereiate MONASTERII.

CHAPTER LVII

# Of the Artificers of the Monastery

SN HOULD there be artificers in the 10 aye

“i Monastery, let them work at 10 Dec. their crafts in all humility, if the Abbot give permission. But if any of them be puffed up by reason of his knowledge of his craft, in that he seemeth to confer some benefit on the Monastery, let such a one be taken from it, and not exercise it again, unless, perchance, when he hath humbled himself, the Abbot bid him work at it anew. And if any of the work of the artificers is to be sold, let those by whom the business is done see that they defraud not the Monastery. Let them ever be mindful of Ananias and Saphira, lest perchance, they, and all who deal fraudulently with the goods of the Monastery, should suffer in their souls the death which these incurred in the body. But with regard to the prices of such things, let not the vice of avarice creep in, but let them always be sold a little cheaper than by men in the world, that God may be glorified in all things.

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CAPUT LVIII.

De DIscIPLINA SUSCIPIENDORUM FRATRUM.

CHAPTER LVIII

# Of the Discipline of receiving Brethren into Religion

ee =O him that newly cometh to change nx Apr. avait, his life, let not an easy entrance 1 Dec. be granted, but, as the Apostle saith, “Try the spirits if they be of God.” If, therefore, he that cometh persevere in knocking, and after four or five days seem patiently to endure the wrongs done to him and the difficulty made about his coming in, and to persist in his petition, let entrance be granted him, and let him be in the guest-house for a few days. Afterwards let him go into the Novitiate, where he is to meditate and study, to take his meals and to sleep. Let a senior, one who is skilled in gaining souls, be appointed over him to watch him with the utmost care, and to see whether he is truly seeking God, and is fervent in the Work of God, in obedience and in humiliations. Let all the hard and rugged paths ° by which we walk towards God be set before him. And if he promise steadfastly to persevere, after the lapse of two months let this Rule be read through to him, with these words : ‘‘ Behold the law, under which thou desirest to fight. Ifthou canst observe

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it, enter in ; if thou canst not, freely depart.” If he still stand firm, let him be taken back to the aforesaid cell of the Novices, and again tried with all patience. And, after a space of six months, let the Rule be again read to him, that he may know unto what he cometh. Should he still persevere, after four months let the same Rule be read to him once more. And if, having well considered within himself, he promise to keep it in all things, and to observe everything that is commanded him, then let him be received into the community, knowing that he is now bound by the law of the Rule, so that from that day forward he cannot depart from the Monastery, nor shake from off his neck the yoke of the Rule, which after such prolonged deliberation he was free either to refuse or to accept.

Let him who is to be received make before 12 Apr. all, in the Oratory, a promise of STABILITY, ee CONVERSION OF LIFE, and OBEDIENCE, in the presence of God and of His saints, so that, if he should ever act otherwise, he may know that he will be condemned by Him Whom he mocketh. Let him draw up this promise in writing, in the name of the saints whose relics are in the altar, and of the Abbot there present. And let him write it with his own hand; or at least, if he knoweth not how, let another write it at his request, and let the Novice put his mark to it, and place it with his own hand

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upon the altar.. When he hath done this, let the Novice himself immediately begin this verse : “ Uphold me, O Lorp, according to Thy Word, and I shall live : and let me not be confounded in my expectation.” And this verse let the whole community thrice repeat, adding thereto Gloria Patri. Then let the newly-received brother cast himself at the feet of all, that they may pray for him, and from that day let him be counted as one of the community. Whatever property he hath let him first bestow upon the poor, or by a solemn deed of gift make over to the Monastery, keeping nothing of it all for himself, as knowing that from that day forward he will have no power even over his own body. Forthwith,

therefore, in the Oratory, let him be stripped of his own garments, wherewith he is clad, and be clothed in those of the Monastery. And let the garments that are taken from him be laid by and kept in the wardrobe ; so that if ever, by the persuasion of the devil, he consent (which God forbid) to leave the Monastery, he may be stripped of the monastic habit and cast forth. But the form of his profession, which the Abbot took from the altar, shall not be given back to him, but be kept in the Monastery.

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CAPUT LIX.

* Note U.—Cum oblatione.

CHAPTER LIX

# Of the Sons of Nobles, or of Poor Men, that are offered

Se any nobleman shall perchance x3 Pak | 6offer his son to God in the 13 Dec. Monastery, let the parents, should the boy be still in infaney, make for him the written promise as aforesaid ; and together with the oblation* let them wrap that promise and the hand of the child in the altar-cloth, and so offer him up. With respect to his property, they must in the same document promise under oath that they will never either themselves, or through any one else, or in any way whatever, give him anything, or the means of having anything. Or else, if they are unwilling to do this, and desire to offer something as an alms to the Monastery, for their own advantage, let them make a donation of whatever they please to the Monastery, reserving to themselves, if they will, the income thereof during their life. Thus let all possiblity of expectation be excluded whereby the child might be deceived and so perish (which God forbid), as we have learnt by experience may happen. Let those who are poorer do in like manner. But those who have nothing whatever may simply make the promise in writing, and with the oblation, offer their son before witnesses.

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CAPUT LX.

CHAPTER LX

# Of Priests who may wish to dwell in the Monastery

peseeeee|F any one in priestly orders ask to 14 Apr. iM Ws be received into the Monastery, «4 Dee RON (Pe et sar. a let not consent be too quickly granted =~ him; but if he persist in his request, let him know that he will have to observe all the discipline of the Rule, and that nothing will be relaxed in his favour, according as it is written : ‘‘ Rriend, wherefore art thou come?” Let him, nevertheless, be allowed to stand next the Abbot, to give the blessing, and to say Mass, if the Abbot bid him do so. Otherwise, let him presume to do nothing, knowing that he is subject to the discipline of the Rule ; but rather let him give an example of humility to all. And if there be a question of any appointment, or other business in the Monastery, let him expect the position due to him according to the time of his entrance, and not that which was yielded to him out of reverence for the priesthood. If any clerics should desire in the same way to be admitted into the Monastery, let them be placed in a middle rank: but in their case also, only on condition that they promise observance of the Rule, and stability therein.

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CAPUT LXI.

stabilitatem suam firmare, non renuatur talis voluntas, et maxime, quia tempore hospitalitatis potuit ejus vita dignosci.

CHAPTER LXI

# Of Stranger Monks, how they are to be received

desire to dwell in the Monastery as a guest, and if he be content with the customs which he there findeth, and do not trouble the Monastery by any superfluous wants, but be satisfied with what he findeth, let him be received for as long a time as he will. And if reasonably and with humility he reprove and point out what is amiss, let the Abbot prudently mark his words, in case God perchance hath sent him for this very end. If afterwards he desire to bind himself to remain there, let not his wish be denied him, especially since during the time he was a guest his manner of life could well be ascertained.

But if during that time he was found 16 Apr. burdensome or prone to vice, not only must ie he not be admitted among the brethren, but he must even be courteously bidden to depart, lest others should be corrupted by his evil living. If, however, he is not such as to deserve to be sent away, let him not merely on his own asking be received and admitted into the community, but

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even be persuaded to remain, that the others may be taught by his example: because in every place we serve one God, and fight under one King. And if the Abbot perceive him to be a man of this kind, he may put him in a somewhat higher place. It shall be in the Abbot’s power to assign ‘not only to a simple monk, but also to any of the aforesaid priests or clerics, a higher place than that due to them by their entrance into the Monastery, if he see that their lives are such as to deserve it. But let the Abbot take care never to receive a monk from any known monastery, without his own Abbot’s consent, and letters of recommendation; as it is written: “ What thou wilt not have done to thyself, do not thou to another.”

CHAPTER LXII

# Of the Priests of the Monastery

Rea any Abbot desire to have a 17 Apr. f ‘ 3 17 Aug. priest or deacon ordained for 17 Dec. his Monastery, let him choose from among his monks one who is worthy to fulfil the priestly office. And let him that is ordained beware of arrogance and pride, and presume to do nothing that is not commanded him by the Abbot, knowing that he is now all the more

subject to regular discipline. Let him not, by



reason of his priesthood, become forgetful of the obedience and discipline of the Rule, but advance ever more and more in godliness. Let him always keep the place due to him according to his entrance into the Monastery, except with regard to his office at the altar, or unless the choice of the community and the will of the Abbot should raise him to a higher place for the merit of his life. Nevertheless, let him know that he must observe the rules prescribed by the deans or provosts. Should he presume to do otherwise, he shall be judged, not asa priest, but as a rebel; and if after frequent warning he do not correct himself, let recourse be had to the intervention of the Bishop.” If even then he will not amend, and his guilt is clearly shewn, let him be cast forth from the Monastery, provided his contumacy be such that he will not submit nor obey the Rule.

CHAPTER LXIII

# Of the Order of the Community

the Monastery, which the time 18 Aus: of his entering religion, the merit of his life, or the appointment of the Abbot shall determine. And let not the Abbot disquiet the flock committed to him, nor by an

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undue use of his authority ordain anything unjustly ; but let him ever bear in mind that he will have to give an account to God of all his judgments and all his deeds. Therefore in that order which. they hold, or which he shall have appointed, let the brethren receive the kiss of peace, approach to Communion, intone the Psalms, and stand in choir. And in no place whatsoever let age decide the order, or be prejudicial to it; for Samuel and Daniel, when but children, judged the elders. Excepting, therefore, those whom (as we have said) the Abbot hath promoted with some special object, or for distinct reasons hath degraded, let all the © rest stand in the order of their coming to religion ;_ so that, for example, he who entered the Monastery at the second hour of the day must know that he is lower than he who came at the first hour, whatever may be his age or dignity. The children are to be kept under discipline at all times and by every one. Let the younger brethren, then, reverence 19 Apr. their elders, and the elder love the younger. ig Dec. In calling each other by name, let none address another by his simple name ; but let the elders call” the younger brethren Brothers, and the younger call their elders Fathers,* by which is implied the reverence due to a father. But let the Abbot, since he is considered to represent the person of Christ, be called Lord and Abbot, not that he hath . taken it upon himself, but out of reverence and

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love for Christ. Let him be mindful of this, and shew himself to be worthy of such an honour. Wherever the brethren meet one another, let the younger ask a blessing from the elder. And when the elder passeth by, let the younger rise, and give place to him to sit down; nor let the younger presume to sit with him, unless the elder bid him, that it may come to pass as it is written: ‘In honour preferring one another.” Let young children and boys take their places in the Oratory, or at table, with all due discipline. In other places also, whereever they may be, let them be under proper care and discipline, until they come to the age of understanding.

CHAPTER LXIV

# Of the Appointment of the Abbot

Romer N the appointing of an Abbot, let 20 Apr. aN NE : Artes 20 Aug. 4, this principle always be observed, 20 Dec.

that he be made Abbot whom all the brethren with one consent in the fear of God, or even a small part of the community with more wholesome counsel, shall elect. Let him who is to be appointed be chosen for the merit of his

life and the wisdom of his doctrine, even though he



should be the last in order in the community. But if all the brethren with one accord (which God forbid) should elect a man willing to acquiesce in their evil habits, and these in some way come to the knowledge of the Bishop to whose diocese that place belongs, or of the Abbots or neighbouring Christians, let them not suffer the consent of these wicked men to prevail, but appoint a worthy steward over the house of God, knowing that for this they shall receive a good reward, if they do it with a pure intention and for the love of God, as, on the other hand, they will sin if they neglect it. Let him that hath been appointed Abbot a: Apr. always bear in mind what a burden he hath apes received, and to Whom he will have to give an account of his stewardship ; and let him know that it beseemeth him more to profit his brethren than to preside over them. He must, therefore, be learned in the Law of God, that he may know whence to bring forth new things and old: he must be chaste, sober, merciful, ever preferring mercy to justice, that he himself may obtain mercy. Let him hate sin, and love the brethren. And even in his corrections, let him act with prudence, and not go too far, lest while he seeketh too eagerly to scrape off the rust, the vessel be broken. Let him keep his own frailty ever before his eyes, and remember that the bruised reed must not be broken. And by this we do not mean that he should suffer



vices to grow up; but that prudently and with charity he should cut them off, in the way he shall see best for each, as we have already said; and let him study rather to be loved than feared. Let him not be violent nor over anxious, not exacting nor obstinate, not jealous nor prone to suspicion, or else he will never be at rest. In all his commands, whether concerning spiritual or temporal matters, let him be prudent and considerate. In the works which he imposeth, let him be discreet and moderate, bearing in mind the discretion of holy Jacob, when he said: “If I cause my flocks to be overdriven, they will all perish in one day.” Taking, then, the testimonies borne by these and the like words to discretion, the mother of virtues, let him so temper all things, that the strong may have something to strive after, and the weak nothing at which to take alarm. And, especially, let him observe this present Rule in all things; so that, having faithfully fulfilled his stewardship, he may hear from the Lorp what that good servant heard, who gave wheat to

his fellow-servants in due season: “Amen, I say unto you, over all his goods shall he place him.”

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CHAPTER LXV

# Of the Provost of the Monastery

é Aug, the appointment of the Provost aa Tiel

grave scandals arise in Monasteries ; since there are some who, puffed up by the evil spirit of pride, and deeming themselves to. be second Abbots, take upon themselves to tyrannise over others, and so foster scandals and cause dissensions in the community : especially in those places where the Provost is appointed by the same Bishop, or the same Abbots as appoint the Abbot himself. How foolish this custom is may easily be seen; for from his first entering upon office an incentive to pride is given to him, the thought suggesting itself that he is freed from the authority of his Abbot, since he hath been appointed by the very same persons. Hence are stirred up envy, quarrels, backbiting, dissensions, jealousy, and disorders. And while the Abbot and Provost are at variance with one another, it must needs be that souls are endangered by reason of their disagreement; and those who are their subjects, while favouring one side or the other, run to destruction. The evil of this peril falleth on the

tel happeneth very often that by 22 Apr.

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heads of those who by their action have been the cause of such disorders.

We foresee, therefore, that it is expedient 23 Apr. for the preservation of peace and charity, ite) that the ordering of the Monastery depend upon the will of the Abbot. If possible, let all the affairs of the Monastery be attended to (as we have already arranged) by Deans, as the Abbot shail appoint ; so that, the same office being shared by many, no one may become proud. But if the needs of the place require it, and the community ask for it reasonably and with humility, and the Abbot judge it expedient, let him himself appoint a Provost, whomsoever he shall choose with the counsel of brethren who fear God. Let the Provost reverently do whatever is enjoined him by his Abbot, and nothing against his will or command ; for the more he is raised above the rest, so much the more carefully ought he to observe the precepts of the Rule. And if the Provost be found culpable or deceived by the haughtiness of pride, or be proved a contemner of the holy Rule, let him be admonished by words until the fourth time, and then fet the correction of regular discipline be applied to him. But if even then he do not amend, let him be deposed from the office of Provost, and another, who is worthier, be substituted in his place. If afterwards he be not quiet and obedient in the community, let him be expelled from the

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CAPUT LXVI.

De Ostiario MONASTERU.

Bute of Bt. Benedict | 181

eee Nevertheless, let the Abbot a in mind that he must give an account to God of at his

judgments, lest perchance the flame of envy or jealousy be kindled in his soul.

CHAPTER LXVI

# Of the Porter of the Monastery

peseeeeyT the gate of the Monastery let 24 Apr. fe 24 Aug. there be placed a wise old man, 24 Dec.

who knoweth how to give and receive

an answer, and whose ripeness of years suffereth him not to wander about. He ought to _ have his cell near the gate, so that they who come may always find some one at hand to give them an answer. As soon as any one shall knock, or a poor man call to him, let him answer, ‘‘ Thanks be to God,” or bid God bless him, and then with all mildness and the fear of God let him give reply without delay, in the fervour of charity. If the porter need help, let him have with him one of the younger brethren.

The Monastery, however, ought if possible to be so constituted that all things necessary, such as water, a mill, and a garden, and the various crafts may be contained within it; so that there may be no need for the monks to go abroad, for this is by no means expedient for their souls. And we wish

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ay animabus eorum. Hanc autem Resa sepius volumus in congregatione legi, ne quis fratrum se de ignorantia excuset.

CAPUT L&VII.

this rule to be frequently read in the community, that none of the brethren may excuse himself on the plea of ignorance.

CHAPTER LXVII

# Of Brethren who are sent on a journey

ie Beha ET the brethren who are about to 25 nye fe 6obe sent on a journey commend 25 Dec. themselves to the prayers of all the brethren and of the Abbot, and at the last prayer of the Work of God let a commemoration be always made of the absent. Let the brethren that return from a journey, on the very day that they come back, lie prostrate on the floor of the Oratory at all the Canonical Hours, while the Work of God is being performed, and beg the prayers of all on account of their transgressions, in case they should perchance upon the way have seen or heard anything harmful, or fallen into idle talk. And let no one presume to relate to another what he may have seen or heard outside the Monastery ; for thence arise manifold evils, If any one shall so presume, let him be subjected to the punishment prescribed by the Rule. And he shall undergo a like penalty, who dareth to leave the enclosure of the Monastery, or to go anywhere, or do anything, however trifling, without permission of the Abbot.

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CAPUT LXIX.

CHAPTER LXVIII

# If a Brother be commanded to do impossibilities

3 on any brother there be laid 26 ree commands that are hard and 26 Dec. impossible, let him receive the orders of him who biddeth him with all mildness and obedience. But if he seeth the weight of the burden altogether to exceed his strength, let him seasonably and with patience lay before his Superior the reasons of his incapacity to obey, without shewing pride, resistance, or contradiction. If, however, after this the Superior still persist in his command, let the younger know that it is expedient for him; and let him obey for the love of God, trusting in His assistance.

CHAPTER LXIX

# That no one presume to defend another in the Monastery

SAAz)ARE must be taken that on no 27 Apr. ¥} occasion one monk presume to 27 Dee defend another in the Monastery, or to take his part, even although they be connected by some near tie of kinship. Let not the monks dare to do this in any way whatsoever ;

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id a monachis presumatur, quia exinde gravissima occasio scandalorum oriri potest. Quod si quis hec transgressus fuerit, acrius coerceatur.

CAPUT LXX.

because therefrom may arise the most grievous occasion of scandals. If any one transgress this rule, let him be very severely punished.

CHAPTER LXX

# That no one presume to strike another

4|ET every occasion of presumption 28 Apr. a | be banished from the Monastery. a Dee IY WZ], We ordain, therefore, that no one be sa allowed to excommunicate or strike any of his brethren, unless authority to do so shall have been given him by the Abbot. Let such as offend herein be rebuked in the presence of all, that the rest may be struck with fear. With regard to the children, however, iet them be kept by all under diligent and watchful discipline, until their fifteenth year: yet this, too, with measure and discretion. For if any one presume, without leave of the Abbot, to chastise such as are above that age, or shew undue severity even to the children, he shall be subjected to the discipline of the Rule, because it is written: ‘ What thou wouldest not have done to thyself, do not thou to another.”

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CHAPTER LXXI

# That the Brethren be obedient one to the other

SHOT only is the excellence of 29 Apr. obedience to be shewn by all a Dee to the Abbot, but the brethren must also obey one another, knowing that by this path of obedience they shall come unto God. The commands, then, of the Abbot or the Superiors appointed by him (to which we allow no private orders to be preferred) having the first place, let ail the younger brethren obey their elders with all charity and vigilance. And should any one be found refractory, let him be corrected. But if a brother be rebuked by the Abbot, or any of his Superiors, for the slightest cause, or if he perceive that the mind of any Superior is even slightly ‘angered or moved against him, however little, let him at once, without delay, cast himself on the ground at his feet, and there remain doing penance until that feeling be appeased, and he giveth him the blessing. If any one should disdain to do this, let him either be subjected to corporal chastisement, or, if he remain obdurate, let him be expelled from the Monastery.

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CAPUT LXXII.

CAPUT LXXIII.

Monasteriis aliquatenus vel honestatem

CHAPTER LXXII

# Of the good zeal which Monks ought to have

( 30 Aug. ness, which separateth from 30 Dec. God, and leads to hell, so there is a good zeal, which keepeth us from vice, and leadeth to God and to life everlasting. ALet monks, therefore, exert this zeal with most fervent love ; that is, “in honour preferring one another.” Let them most patiently endure one another’s infirmities, whether of body or of mind. Let them vie with one another in obedience. Let no one follow what he thinketh good for himself, but rather what seemeth good for another. Let them cherish fraternal charity with chaste love, fear God, love their Abbot with sincere and humble affection, and prefer nothing whatever to Christ. And may He bring us all alike to life everlasting. |

CHAPTER LXXIII

# That the whole observance of perfection is not set down in this Rule

pase have written this Rule, in order: May i) that, by observing it in Monas- 32 ee teries, we may shew ourselves to have some degree of goodness of life, anda

beginning of holiness. But for him who would

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pervenies.

hasten to the perfection of religion, there are the teachings of the holy Fathers, the following whereof bringeth a man to the height of perfection. For what page or what word is there in the divinelyinspired books of the Old and New Testaments, that is not a most unerring rule for human life? Or what book of the holy Catholic Fathers doth not loudly proclaim how we may by a straight course reach our Creator? Moreover, the Conferences of the Fathers, their Institutes and their Lives, and the Rule of our holy Father Basil—what are these but the instruments whereby wellliving and obedient monks attain to virtue? But to us, who are slothful and negligent and of evil lives, they are cause for shame and confusion. Whoever, therefore, thou art that hasteneth to thy heavenly country, fulfil by the help of Christ this least of Rules which we have written for beginners ; and then at iength thou shalt arrive, under God’s protection, at the lofty summits of doctrine and virtue of which we have spoken above.

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Note A (p. 14).—Fortissimum genus. The special fortitude here attributed by St. BENnepict to the cenobitical life consists in the perpetual and absolute submission to the will of another which that life entails. Some commentators see in the word fortissimum an allusion to the greater strength and security of community life as compared with the eremitical: inasmuch as where two or three . are gathered together, there our Lorp Himself, the tower of strength—turris fortitudinis—has speciaily promised to be in the midst of them. See Perez, Comment. in S. Reg.; also Turrecremata, 7bid.

Notre B (p. 40).—Rara loquendi concedatur licentia. ‘St. Benepict,”’ observes Calmet, “as well as all the ancient Rules, preserves an unbroken silence on the subject of recreation.”” Nevertheless it appears certain, not only from this but from other passages in the Holy Rule, that conversation was not intended to be absolutely prohibited. Thus the brethren are directed (chap. xxxi.) to ask at proper times for what they require ; not to converse with one another except at proper times (chap. xlviii.) ; and again (chap. xlix.) to talk less than usual during Lent. From very early times, fixed periods were appointed for conversation. The statutes of Adelard (circ. 822 a.p.) permit talking in the dormitory

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on certain occasions—the Ordo Cluniacensis, of the 11th century, lays down fixed rules

and times for conversation in the cloister—and the early constitutions both of the Carthusian and Cistercian Orders explicitly legislate for conversations at regular times. (See Ven. Guigo, Siatut. Carthus.,c.7, and Monastic. Cisterciens., p. 328, c. 5.) It is curious to note that it was anciently permitted to talk only on ferial days: silence and recollection were strictly prescribed on all festivals, propter festivitatum reverentiam ; and this pious custom still prevails in some religious houses, e.g., in certain convents of the Canonesses Regular of St. John Lateran.

Note C (p. 46).—Voluntas habet penam, et necessitas parit coronam—z.e. the necessity, selfimposed upon the monk, of living in subjection to the will of another, the reward of which will be a crown of glory hereafter. These words are not to be found in Holy Scripture, and it has been conjectured in consequence that by Scripture Sr. Benepict alludes to the writings of the Fathers, or early monastic saints. No such passage, however, is known to exist ; and the reference is probably, as Paul the Deacon, Smaragdus and others have supposed, to the general sense of Scripture on the subject, rather than to any particular passage. Cf. Prov. xxi. 28 ; “Eccles. xviii. 30 ; 2b, xliitg oe ib, viii. 18; 2 Tim. iv.8; James i.12; 1 Peter v. 4; Apoc. ii. 10. | ;

In the Rule of St. Augustine, it is interesting to note, occur the words, ubi scribtum est: Abominatio est Domino defigens omnium; and this passage also is generally interpreted as being the general sense of Holy Scripture.

Note D (p. 54).—Ostava hora. The Romans divided the night as well as the day into twelve

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equal divisions or hours; but as the night commenced at sunset and continued till sunrise, the length of these hours would vary according to the season, being longer in winter and shorter in summer. Calculated in this way, the eighth hour of the night would of course vary with the time of year, as well as with the latitude of the various countries. At mid-winter, in the latitude of Rome, the eighth hour would commence about 3 A.m., and end about 4. Sr. Benepicr seems to lay down in this chapter that the hour for the night-office is to vary according to the above mode of reckoning. (See Perez, Comment., c. viii. 13.) Paul the Deacon, however, with Turrecremata and others, interprets the words juxta considerationem rationts to mean that the eighth hour was always to be calculated from the same time, either from the first of November or the vernal equinox.

The meditatio, in which the Rule prescribes that the time remaining after the night-office is to be spent, means, as is evident from the context, study, and not meditation in the modern sense of the word. St. Benepict does not lay down any fixed time for mental prayer, apart from the Divine Office. We know, however, that it was the regular practice in his monasteries, from his life by St. Gregory (Dialogues, Bk. ii. c. 4), which speaks of “the hour when the singing of psalms was ended, and the monks betook themselves to prayer.”

Note E (p. 62).—Data benedictione. The benedictio here referred to is the collect, or prayer of the day, said after the Gospel. The word benedictio is often used with the signification of prayer : é.g.. in chaps. xxxv. and xxxviii., where the weekly reader and

servers are directed to receive the blessing before entering on their offices. So, conversely, in ch. xlix., the word oratio is used in the

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sense of the blessing given by the Abbot: ‘ Quod unusquisque offert, cum ejus fiat oratione et voluntate.”

Norte F (p. 62).—Aliquid de lectionibus breviandum. Anciently the length of the lessons was not fixed as at present, but the signal for their conclusion was given by the Superior, who, when he thought fit, pronounced the words Tu autem Domine, the reader concluding muserere nobis. Charlemagne, we are told, when presiding at the office in his private chapel, coughed (signum ex gutture faciebat) as a signal for the reader to cease. In some monasteries it was the custom for the cantor to mark previously with a drop of wax, or with his finger-nail, the point where the lessons were to conclude. The present discipline of the Church, which has not only fixed the length of the lessons, but binds every professed monk to the recitation of the Office in its integrity, has of course superseded the injunction here given by Sr. BENEDICT.

Note G (p. 62).—In directum. Bernard of M. Cassino and Calmet suppose this to mean simple recitation without chant. The more probable interpretation is that the verses are to be said consecutively, unlike, ¢.g., the psalm Venite at matins, which is interspersed with antiphons. Dom Leclerg, in an article in the ‘ Dictionnaire d’ Archéologie Chrétienne” (fasc. viii., col. 2299) gives reasons for his opinion that a psalm recited in directum was said by the whole choir together, not by alternate sides; and this view is corroberated by a rubric in the Ambrosian Breviary: ‘ Psalmus directus in Dominicis diebus qui ab utroque choro stante dicitur communiter, et non alternatim.” (See Note K.)

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Notre H (p. 66)—Scandalorum spinas. In order to remind the brethren of the duty of mutual concord and charity, and the scandalous consequences of the opposite vices, St. Benepicr here orders an exception to the general practice of saying the Lord’s Prayer in secret, which was part of the disciplina arcant of the early Church. The Prayer was considered too sacred to be used or even heard by those not fully initiated into the Faith; and hence the catechumens, who left the Church at the offertory of the Mass, would not be present at the solemn chanting of the Pater noster. In the Roman Office the Lord’s Prayer is still said in secret wherever it occurs, with very few exceptions.

The Litanic spoken of in this chapter are the Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, &c., immediately preceding the Pater noster and Collect, with which the Office concludes.

Note | (p. 70).—Misse sint. The word missa is used by ecclesiastical writers in various significations: 1, The sacrifice of the Mass; 2, the lessons sung at the Night-office ; 3, a canonical hour itself (cf. Cassian, lib. II., c. 13—“ Post missam nocturnam dormire non oportet”’)*; 4, a coilect or prayer said at the end of the Office (Concil. Milevitanum, can, 12. “ Orationes seu misse que _ prohibitz fuerint in Concilio”); 5, instead of missio, as at the end of Mass: “ Ite, missa est’’—‘‘ Go, you are dismissed.” (So St. Cyprian uses remissa

for remissio.) The word can only be used here in one of the two latter senses ; and though both interpretations have found advocates, the former, namely,

* So Shakespere, in the well-known passage (Romeo and Juliet, Act iv. Se. 1),

‘Or shall I come to you at evening mass ?” evidently alludes to the hour of vespers.



that referring it to the final prayer or collect, is supported by the principal commentotors, as Bernard of M. Cassino, Turrecremata, Caramuel, Boherius, Martene, &c. It is certain, from the Holy Rule itself, that a prayer was prescribed at the end of the Office (see chap. Ixvii.) ; and it would therefore be natural to find it ordered here, where directions for the Divine Office are being minutely laid down by St. BENeEpIcT.

Nore K (p. 70).—Si vero minor, in directum psallantur. Calmet well points out here that what. is prescribed, in the case of a small community, cannot be the mere omission of the antiphon before and after the Psalms, which would make no appreciable difference in the length of the Office. The learned F. Tomasi (Ju Responsoria et Antiphonaria Eccl. Roman., 1686) has shewn that it was anciently the custom to interpolate an antiphon, often after every verse of the psalm, as is still the case at the Venite of matins, and as we find in Ps. cxxxv., where the words ‘‘ For His mercy endureth for ever’ are added as an antiphon to each verse. It was no doubt this frequent repetition of the antiphon which St. Benenpicr allowed to be omitted. (See Note G.)

Congregatio minor is usually interpreted to mean one consisting of less than twelve members, which was the primitive number of a Benedictine Community. St. Gregory (Dialogues, B. ii., c. 3) tells us that Sr. Begnepicr “built [at Subiaco] twelve Abbeys, and in each of them he placed twelve monks.”

Norte L (p. 80).—In uno loco dormiant. This rule was strictly observed for many centuries. Separate cells are expressly forbidden in all the ancient Rules; and in a.p. 1341 we find the General



Chapter of the English Benedictines, and a hundred years later that of Cluny, repeating the same prohibition. The dormitory was only entered at night, and everything in the way of reading and study in the early monasteries was carried on in the cloister, from which seculars were for centuries strictly excluded.

Nore M (p. 88).—Sympectas: from the Greek oup-maifew, literally play fellows, collusores, and hence those who combine together for any purpose —not necessarily an unlawful one, as is now implied by ‘‘collusion.” The sympectc here referred to may perhaps signify those brethren who had been brought up in the Monastery from childhood with the delinquent, and might thus be supposed to have special influence with him ; or, more probably, the allusion is to the combination, or conspiracy, so to speak, between the Abbot and some of the elder and more discreet members of his community, with the object of bringing the refractory brother to a better mind.

Note N (p. 96).—Sine typo. So all the MSS., but the word is nevertheless clearly not from tuzog (a figure or image) but from tédos—pride (literally, the smoke obscuring the soul). The word typhus in this sense is not uncommon in late Latin. Cf. Arnobius I]. 43, &. So St. Augustine (E'pist. xxii. 29), speaking of the oblations at funerals, says that they should be offered '' sine typho et cum alacritate.' And St. Gregory speaks of typhus superbie (Epist. 1. vi. 8). Both these passages have typhus in some MSS., owing, possibly, to the transcriber's ignorance of Greek, and to the consequently unfamiliar look of the word in its Latin form.

Note O (p. 104).—Usque ad missas sustineant. That is, until after Holy Communion,



which the servers would approach, with the rest of the Community, on all Sundays and holidays, at the one mass which was then celebrated in the Monastery. We see by this passage that Sr. Benepict inculcated the duty of communicating on all festivals of the Church, in emulation of the Egyptian and Syrian monks, who, as Cassian tells us (III. 2), observed the same pious practice. We learn from the early Rules that the monks were accustomed to communicate standing ; and this was continued by the Congregation of Cluny, among others, down to later times.

Nore P (p. 110)—Mixtum .. . propter Communionem sanctam. The mixtum here spoken of is, according to the best authority, a small portion of bread and wine, identical with the biberes et panem prescribed in chap. 35. Sr. Benepicr allows it to the reader, before commencing his duty, for two distinct reasons: one, lest he might find his task too laborious, if undertaken fasting: the other, to prevent any inconvenience or involuntary irreverence which might be entailed by the effort of reading aloud a short time after communicating. The most ancient commentators are unanimous in this interpretation of the words propter Communionem sanctam; and the Regula Magistri, which was written, according to Mabillon (De Studiis monasticts, II. 13), as early as the 7th century, and is in great part an amplification of the Rule of St. Benspict, has this direction for the reader: 'Ipse suum merum propter sputum sacrament accipiat, et tunc incipiat legere." Connected with this custom, of course, are the ablutions prescribed in the celebration of Mass, and also the practice, still observed in many places, of giving to the faithful a little wine or water immediately after Communion.



Perez sees in this expression of St. BrNEDICT evidence that the practice of daily Commuuion prevailed in the early monasteries ; but the words are probably intended to apply only to the dies solemniores, which are expressly mentioned in the analogous case of the weekly servers (chap. xxxv.).

Note Q (p. 118).—Infirmis intellectibus non evit utile. The Heptateuch (or Books of Moses and Josue) and the Books of the Kings would be considered too exciting to the imagination to be suitable for reading immediately before retiring to rest. We read that Ulphilas, bishop of the Goths, omitted the Books of Kings in his translation of the Scriptures into the

vernacular, fearing lest the perusal of them might inflame the naturally warlike dispositions of his flock.

Note R (p. 126).—Infantes . . . vapulent. The infantes or puert referred to here and elsewhere in the Holy Rule were not boys receiving their education in the Monastery in view of some secular career, but were the alumni, properly so called, or youthful aspirants to religious life, who wore the habit, and assisted at the Divine Office and other monastic exercises. (See post, Note V.) The following passage from the Ordo Cluniacensis of Bernard, drawn up in the 11th century, curiously illustrates the fidelity with which the instructions of St. BENEDICT were carried out in medizval times.

Note S (p. 138).—Geratur aut condatur. The meaning is clear, although somewhat elliptically ex-

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pressed. Nothing was to be done in the Oratory, and nothing kept there (condainr), except what pertained to the due celebration of the Divine Service.

Note T (p. 142).—Petita benedictione. That is, after respectfully saluting the guest. Benedicite was the ordinary form of greeting.

Note U (p. 144).—Eulogias. Benedictiones. This word is used by ancient writers, both in its Greek and Latin form, in the sense of gifts or presents. [hus in 1 Kings xxv. 27, Abigail, referring to the presents she is offering to David, says: ‘‘Wherefore, receive this blessing (benedictionem : in LAX. version eddéyrav) which thy handmaid hath brought to thee.” The word, as used here by St. BENEDICT, may bear the same meaning ; but it is generally understood in the stricter ecclesiastical sense of the bread or small cakes which were blessed during Mass, and given to the faithful in token of their being in full communion with the Church. The Eulogia is still given in parts of France, and also in the Greek Church, where it is known by the name of dvtidwpov, as being a kind of substitute for Holy Communion. It was a monastic custom of the highest antiquity that these eulogie, or blest cakes, should be distributed to the brethren in the refectory, before beginning their meal. The Capitula Monachorum Augiensium (circ. 813 4.D.) prescribe as follows: ‘In refectorio, data benedictione, veniant duo presbyteri ad Abbatem, et dant ipsi eulogium ceteris fratribus.” So in the Capttulare Aquisgranense (A.D. 816), cap. Ixvii. ‘ Ut eulogize Fratribus a presbyteris in refectorio dentur.’ Cf. Regula Magisiri, c. 76.

The object of the prohibition laid down by St. BENEDICT is of course to discourage particular

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friendships, or marks of individual affection, as opposed to the spirit of community life.

Note V (p. 158).--Cum oblatione. An offering, that is, of bread and wine, which was made by the parents at the offertory of the Mass in which their child was dedicated tou God. (Statuta Lanfranc, c. 18; Ordo Cluniacensis, c. 27.) Mere intants were sometimes offered in this way; but most of the ancient monastic constitutions forbade them to be received

before they had attained the age of reason, and could distinguish right from wrong. The ratification of the parents' act was conditional on the subsequent consent of the child, whose final and solemn consecration to religion could not take place until his fifteenth year. The Council of Trent afterwards (Sess. XXV., cap. 15) fixed the age for profession at sixteen years complete; and Pius IX., by a decree promulgated in 1857, further ordained that simple vows only should be taken at the end of the novitiate, and that the final and crowning act of solemn profession should not take place until three years more had elapsed.

The Ordo Cluniacensis of Bernard, already cited, contains (cap. 17) a detailed account of the discipline and mode of education of these alumnz, or youthful monks, in one of the most important medizval -monasteries. The writer-concludes his account with the expression of his opinion that "it is hard to see how a king's son could be brought up with greater care in a palace than the youngest boy receives in the Abbey of Cluny." (From the Vetus Disciplina Monastica, Paris, 1726.)

Note X (p. 166).—Episcopus adhibeatur in testimonium. These words are usually interpreted to mean that the Bishop was to be actually called upon to intervene in the case of a refractory priest.

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Taken in conjunction with the appeal to the Ordinary prescribed in the event of an improper election to the abbacy (chap. Ixiv.), they seem to shew that St. Benenpict did not, in laying down his Rule, contemplate that exemption from episcopal authority which his Order afterwards enjoyed. It has been maintained, indeed, that no trace of such exemption is to be found previous to the time of St. Gregory the Great (590-604). KF. Bouix, however (De jure Regularium, \l., cap. 2. § 1), clearly shews- that there were instances of this immunity, at least in the Eastern and African Churches, two centuries or more before the above date, and therefore considerably anterior to the time of St. BENEDICT.

Note Y (p. 168).—Nonnos. This designation continued for many centuries to be applied to the elder members of the monastic Community. Bernard of M. Cassino, in his commentary (of the end of the 13th century) speaks of nonnus Remigius, nonnus Jacobus, &c. The title of Nonnus was afterwards superseded (except among the Cistercians, who still retain it) by that of Domnus, of which indeed some have maintained it to be merely another form. The word is found in late Latin writers in the sense of 'tutor' or "master."

Inscr. ap. Zaccaria, Stor. lett. d' Italia, tom ix., p. 492.) It is probably of Egyptian origin, and was applied in very early times to the monks and nuns of Egypt. (Vid. S. Jerome, Epist. 117, No. 6, and 22,No.16. Vite Patrum, passim, &c.) It occurs frequently also in the African Church, as a proper name: we read of a St. Nonnus, an Abbot Nonnus, and others. The mother of St. Gregory Nazianzen was named Nonna. The word still survives in our "nun" (=nonna).

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